

LE7547 Course Notes

The Leader's Inner Journey

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I. A Rationale & Encouragement for this Course:

1. Jeremiah, prophet of the OT

Jeremiah wept for the shepherds of Israel, many centuries ago, and perhaps we need to do the same for our Christian workers today. Jeremiah 50:6-7

2. Canadian research amongst the clergy marriages.

Research done amongst the clergy of Canada about 7 years ago, revealed that 80% of the spouse of pastor's, said: *My husband has two brides and I am number 2, their ministry is number 1.*

3. Christianity Today Research.

300 pastors surveyed, 23% sexually inappropriate with women, of the 23% Only 4% said they were found out.

4. Research of a counselor who specializes in this form of counseling.

Peter Steinke, Counselor for pastors in Texas:

- Based his findings on 350 ministers in his care over a 7 year period:
- 65 of them had been involved in sexual affairs before coming to therapy.
- 75 of the 350 admitted to having difficulties in their marriages.

-The affairs usually involved partners in close proximity to work: Those Who served in music ministry, secretaries, and counselees?

6. Statistics of Harry Schaumburg. www.stonegateministries.org

Residential sex addict center in the Rockies.

63% of clients are pastors or missionaries

92% success rate because he won't take them until they hit bottom, past denial

Root of the Problem: Common Denominators Found:

(Quoted from the Secrets of Your Family Tree)

1. Hidden or repressed anger, often involving unresolved conflicts from the past.
2. Endless living in the fast lane.
3. The superstar syndrome.
4. Habitually hiding one's own deep legitimate needs.
5. Operating without a personal support system.
6. Establishing only superficial relationships with others.
7. Allowing expectations of one and others to drive one to the point of exhaustion and burnout.

Some Unhealthy Characteristics of Christian Workers

Co-dependent helpers who miss the balance of Gal. 6:2-5.

1. Gal. 6:2- Burdens (Baros) = come alongside of them when the situation is more than anyone can bear emotionally, alone

2. Gal. 6:5- Load (Phortion) = that which God intends for us to do alone with him. Not violating the teaching of Matt. 18.

Be aware of the following traps:

1. Feeling undue responsibility for others, a compulsion always to fix what ails others.
2. Saying yes when they mean no, being people pleasers.
3. Doing for others what they (others) are capable of doing for themselves.
4. Seeking to be all things to all people.
5. Feeling good about them only when they are giving to others.
6. Being primarily motivated by interpersonal and social rewards.
7. Feeling exclusively attracted to needy people.
8. Feeling bored, empty, and even worthless if there isn't a problem to solve or someone needing help.
9. Continually abandoning a schedule or important project for the sake of someone else's needs.
10. Over-committing themselves and then feeling harassed and under pressure.
11. Often feeling guilty when spending money on personal needs.
12. Fearing rejection if they are not constantly ministering to others.
13. Overly sensitive and taking things personally.
14. Being overly afraid of making mistakes.
15. Being driven by perfectionism, self-imposed standards.

A codependent person is one who depends on satisfying the needs of others in order to feel his or her own value.

Consider the balance of Phil. 2:3 & 4:

Do nothing out of selfish ambition or vain conceit, but in humility consider others better than you. Each of you should look not only to our own interests, but also to the interests of others.

Encouragement and Challenge:

What secrets and unfinished business are hidden in each of us? What powerful hold needs to be faced? Is there a pattern you do not want to replicate in the future? Remember James 5:16

If these issues are not dealt with, the cycle of sin will probably continue. In searching our own hearts, let us remember that families reproduce in kind, and let that motivate us.

*Christ longs to make all things new for us, and He has given us the freedom of choice. He never forces His will on us. In the light of God's holiness, let us choose to resolve our unfinished business by...confronting, resolving, and releasing our secrets. Then we will no longer be bound by them and will not pass them on to our children.
(Secrets of Your Family Tree, Foreword by Chuck Swindol*

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5 Principles that can help, if you make them your own:

(Quoted from Secrets of Your Family Tree ch. 5)

1. I will never forget that I am in a spiritual battle. I Peter 5:8-9a

Be alert to the presence of the evil one and aware of his brilliant strategies for demoralizing, discouraging, and defeating you in any way possible.

2. I will first take my problems to God. I will fight my best battles on my knees. James 5:16b

Remain fervent in prayer, never hesitating to call down power from God Almighty.

3. I will decide to be accountable to God and some other spiritually mature individuals of the same sex, remembering that alone I am inadequate to fight my own battles. James 5:16a

Refuse to retaliate to take revenge in the energy of the flesh.

4. I will follow the path of obedience no matter how intense the pressure, and I will remember this whenever temptation confronts me. II Cor. 15:58

Refuse to slacken, surrender or quit.

5. I will aim to please God more than people. I will enjoy life within biblical guidelines with a free conscience. I will not be bound by the traditions of men. I will always remember that in Christ there is victory. Psm. 20:5a, Jude 24-25

Glorify your Lord and God, trust His Word regardless

II. Preparatory Reflections.

Instructions: As we process through these questions, I want you to consider the questions posed and simply write answers in the space below, as we proceed. You can get the ppt. from the professor at the end of the course.

Reflection: Ask Yourself: Remember Phil. 2:13, God works in the willing department before the doing.

-Strengths?

-Weaknesses?

Reproducibility: If someone followed you, what would you hope they didn't repeat or model from you??

Satan's personal agenda for you?

1. Get you down on you and beating yourself up for all your past and present weaknesses.
2. Get you to live in denial about that which is not reproducible in you.
3. Why? So you won't allow the transforming work of the Holy Spirit to change you.

Prayer-Warfare:

We are at war and the enemies of our souls are intent on taking us out. Let's stand together for each other in this course during this time of learning and awareness.

My Prayer for all who own the identity of "Learner"

-For an awareness which would be met with application of truth.

Key Leadership Reality:

-You cannot lead others beyond your own authentic healing-freedom in Christ-Growth in discipleship.

Paul's Prayer for YOU: Ephesians 1:17-20...Look it up.

"For this reason, ever since I heard about your faith in the Lord Jesus and your love for all the saints..."

"Give you the spirit of wisdom and revelation..."

"May be enlightened in order that you may know the..."

"and His incomparably great power for us..."

III. Introduction to the Course.

This course is designed to help the potential or existing leader, take a deeper look toward the goal of self awareness, discovery and inner growth. The balance of adding emotional maturity to spiritual maturity can be discovered in the process of this course material and application. The course will take the student in a different direction than most, in that; it will also look at building weaknesses by focusing on our strengths.

The effectiveness of any given leader is directly proportionate to their willingness to find inner health. It is out of one's inner health that a leader finds life, that which is then reproducible in others.

Goal of this study:

Missional: Making Incarnation your model for loving well.

Peter Scazzero

BY:

1. Entering another's world
2. Holding onto yourself
3. Hanging between two worlds

Leadership Development Theory – Timeline

Dr. Robert Clinton, *the Making of a Leader*

Instructions:

1. As you understand the following information regarding the developmental stages of a leader...identify now and throughout this entire course...experiences along your journey.
2. In the course of this course, you will come to a clearer understanding of where you are actually on the continuum offered. Make note where you think you are at present and come back to this at the end of the course.

Phase 1	Phase 2	Phase 3	Phase 4	Phase 5	Phase 6
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Phase 1: Sovereign Foundations

God providentially works foundational items into the life of the leader-to-be. Personality characteristics, spiritual gifts, natural talents, experiences good and bad, and the time context will be used by God as He is allowed to bring them to a place of awareness and then guided development.

Phase 2: Inner-Life Growth

An emerging leader usually receives some kind of training, informally and/or formally. It would seem that the major thrust of this stage is ministry training, but God's major thrust is development inward. The real training process is in the heart of the person, where God is doing some growth testing.

Caution: Most people are anxious to get past this stage and on into ministry. Rushing this process will be to the young leader's detriment; because they need to understand that God is accenting this truth; leaders' are to minister out of "**being**" before "**doing**".

Phase 3: Ministry Maturing

The emerging leader gets into ministry as a prime focus of life. This often includes additional formal training. The practice of ministry will reveal the skills that are lacking and give the leader opportunity to focus on who God has made them to be. The willingness to embrace the discovery and healing of Phase 2 will be demonstrated in the teach-ability of the leader in this stage.

Phase 4: Life Maturing

The leader identifies and uses his or her gift-mix with power and confidence. This is mature fruitfulness. This is a period in which giftedness emerges along with priorities.

Phase 5: Convergence

The leader is moved by God into a role that matches gift-mix, experience, temperament, etc. Not many leaders experience convergence because they allow themselves to be promoted to roles that hinder their gift-mix. It is in this phase that the best mentoring and coaching occurs for other younger leaders.

Phase 6: Afterglow or Celebration

The older leader has built up a lifetime of contacts and continues to exert influence in these relationships. The fact that others are seeking them out for advice and information is a result of their consistent track record.

Remember: This is a continuum which indicates a progression as the tasks of one phase are completed over a period of time. The leader then moves on into the next phase. It is possible to appear in a later phase when in reality you are stuck in an earlier phase. This will usually result in:

1. Unsettledness in your current role of ministry and context.
2. Never landing on the right fit for ministry.
3. Finishing poorly in the end, unless you make course corrections now and seek help in honest coaching or consultation.

Reflection:

4. What phase of leadership development are you in, currently?
5. Why do you place yourself in this phase?
3. Any surprises or new awareness?

I. Discipleship's Next Frontier: Emotional Health & Maturity.

Quote: *With one breath, God has made us human. Yet, somehow, today we slice out the emotional portion of who we are, deeming it suspect, irrelevant, or of secondary importance. Contemporary discipleship models often lift up the spiritual over the physical, emotional, social and intellectual components of who we are. Nowhere, however, does a good biblical theology allow for such a division. Peter Scazzero*

A. A Paradigm Shift in Discipleship.

1. Thesis: *Emotional health and spiritual health are inseparable. It is not possible for a Christian to be spiritually mature while remaining emotionally immature.*
2. *The church is to be the primary vehicle for our spiritual and emotional maturity.*
Mt. 18:20...2 or 3 gathered in my name, there am I in their midst

James 5:16...confess your faults one to another and be healed.
3. Development psychology: Sheds light on healthy vs. unhealthy relating.

What level of Maturity do you bring to your Work Team?

Dependent:

1. I need, I need
2. Waiting for others to make all the decisions and contributions
3. Passive-aggressive: won't let you know they disagree, but will undermine you.
4. Draining to a ministry team

Independent:

1. My way or the highway
2. Line rangers
3. I don't need you; I can do it without you. I will do it all myself
4. Bossy, offensive

Interdependent:

1. Team player
2. Negotiate through decisions together
3. Respect for others
4. The one another's of scripture, give and receive, ability to be taught and to teach

4. Church environments for Emotional & Spiritual Maturity.
(Dr. Gary Sweeten-EMI)

The family of God, the healthy church (individual and gathered) comes alongside us in different and developmental ways. These are the environmental settings in which this family of God needs to influence us...if we are to truly find emotional and spiritual health.

(Describe these from your personal experience, as we discuss):

- a. Hospital – for mending.
 - b. School – for molding.
 - c. Army – for mobilizing on mission with Jesus.
5. The overall health of any church or gathered family of God depends primarily on the emotional and spiritual health of its leadership. In addition, the key to successful spiritual leadership has more to do with which one of the following, than the other:
- a. The leader's expertise, gifts and experience?
 - b. The leader's internal life?

Take the "Emotional Maturity Inventory." Then score it as instructed in the notes within the inventory.

B. Awareness around Defense Mechanisms and Self-Defense.

1. Presuppositions: I John 1:4 – 2:2

- a. Our goal is to walk in the Light and enjoy fellowship with God and others.
- b. Walking in the Light is not moral perfection; it is living in complete agreement with God.
- c. We are to consciously agree with God concerning our present condition and trust in Christ as our only Defense. I Pet. 2:23

2. Defense Mechanisms - Ways We Deceive Ourselves: (Dr. Neil Anderson Seminar Material).

- a. **Denial of reality:** attempt to protect ourselves by refusing to perceive or face unpleasanties.
 - 1) Avoidance = a conscious refusal to deal with issues.
 - 2) Suppression = a conscious denial where we internalize the problem and attempt to live as though it did not exist. (Psm. 32).
 - 3) Repression = an unconscious denial where we attempt to prevent painful or dangerous thoughts from reaching the conscious level.
- b. **Fantasy:** a gratification of frustrated desires by imaginary achievements. (II Cor. 10:5, I Pet. 1:13). *Root of addiction.*
- c. **Identification:** increasing feelings of worth by identifying self with another person or institution of illustrious standing (I Cor. 3:4-5).
- d. **Reaction formation:** preventing dangerous desires from being expressed by exaggerating opposed attitudes and types of behavior and using them as barriers. (Rom. 2:1).
EX. Pastor who rails against pornography obsessively probably is struggling with this sin.
- e. **Emotional insulation:** withdrawal into passivity to protect self from hurt (II Cor. 4:8-9, 12:9).

- f. **Isolation:** failure to recognize the whole situation in order to live only the part that is good. (John 4:16-19).
- g. **Regression:** retreating to earlier developmental levels involving less mature responses and usually a lower level of aspiration. (Joshua 7:7).
- h. **Displacement:** discharging pent-up feelings, usually of hostility, on objects less dangerous than those which aroused the feelings.

3. Defense Mechanisms: Ways We Defend Ourselves.

- a. **Compensation:** covering up weaknesses by emphasizing desirable traits or making up for frustration in one area by over gratification in another (Matt. 19:16f).
- b. **Projection:** placing blame for difficulties upon others or attributing one's own unethical desires to others (Lk. 10:38f).
- c. **Rationalization:** attempting to prove that one's behavior is rational, justifiable, and worthy of self and social approval (Lk. 18:10-14).

C. Personal Application from the Emotional Maturity Inventory.

1. Of the 6 major areas measured by this inventory, where were you:
 - a. Least emotionally mature?
 - b. Most emotionally mature?
2. Is God beginning to single out at least one area where He might want you to seek Him for healing and growth?

3. How is God beginning to speak into our life?

4. God uses 3 channels to communicate truth and love to us:

- a. Through the Cosmos or created order and universe. Psm. 19:1-3, Romans 1:20 (**Observation – General Revelations.**)
- b. Through the Rhemia or witness of His Spirit within our hearts and minds. (Heb. 4:12, Eph. 6:17 (**Emotional- Heart.**)
- c. Through the Logos, the living Jesus and the written scriptures.
- d. **Alethia** = *All of the above 3 channels. John 8:32, the truth shall set you free. Truth is this word.*

5. Reflectors of the image of God.

- a. All facets of our being are designed to reflect the image of God in us.
- b. Sin tarnishes or distorts those reflections.
- c. Finding freedom in Christ through application of the truth of God...applied at both head and a heart level...begins to clear up the distortions.
- d. Limbic Lag:
 - 1) Neo-Cortex- thinking control center of the brain. This part will change its mind with trusted new information, almost immediately. (Head)
 - 2) Limbic System- Feelings control center. This part must see it, taste it, and hear it again and again and finally embraces as true. Experiential knowledge (Heart)

e. Knowing Who You Are “IN CHRIST-Identity

D. Determining Safe Confessional Relationships in which to Share Your Scores. (Taken from *Hiding from Love*, by John Townsend, pp.277-279).

- 1. People who react to you in a different way than those who have offended you.**
- 2. People who, over time, have a loving track record.**
- 3. People who can be observed from some emotional distance.** Take small risks in vulnerability before taking bigger risks. I Tim. 5:22, I John 4:1. Many individuals are badly hurt by committing themselves to openness in relationships in which the others cannot handle that level of honesty and thus become critical, defensive or parental.
- 4. People with the ability to accept imperfections in others.**
- 5. People, who are not strangers to pain, yet are recovering themselves.**
- 6. People who are aware of their own deficits.**
- 7. People who have truth without condemnation.**
- 8. People who have grace without license.**
- 9. People whom bare good fruit in your life.**

“Whatever is un-confessed is beyond the reach of healing!”

Exercise: *If willing, find a trusted person and share the following with each other.*
(All sharing stays in the group, we must honor with confidentiality)

- Your two lowest score's title, on the Emotionally Maturity Inventory.

- As you share each of the two lowest score titles, share any insights, as to why you think these were your lowest s
- Pray for the others in your triad, focus on a prayer of encouragement; in regards to what was shared

II. Brief Introduction to Emotional Intelligence (Dr. Laura Belsten) (Coaching Emotional Intelligence Training Material)

A. Emotional Intelligence.

Definition: *Emotional intelligence is a dimension of intelligence that's responsible for our ability to be aware of our own emotions and the emotions of others and then use that awareness to manage ourselves and manage our relationships with others.*

- Unlike IQ, this score can change and grow.
- Emotionally immature people will not do well in this scoring.

Success considerations: *Research indicates that our success in life and work is attributable about 80% to emotionally intelligence and only about 20% to our cognitive intelligence.*

6. Evaluation of one's emotional intelligence: *Emotional intelligence is measured on the basis of 4 quadrants. This work is attributed to Daniel Goldman and his research team. The four quadrants are:*
 - a. Self Awareness:

-Emotional Self Awareness- noticing and being able to label your feelings, emotions, “gut-level” instincts or reactions; being able to connect these to their source; recognizing their effects on your mind and your body; using your feelings as a valuable source of insight and information about yourself, others and the situations around you.

-Accurate Self Assessment- an inner awareness of your strengths and limitations.

-Personal Power- a sense of self-confidence and an inner knowing that you can meet life’s challenges and live the life you choose.

b. Self Management:

-Emotional Self Control- keeping disruptive emotions and impulses in check.

-Integrity- maintaining high standards of honesty & ethics at all times; living out values.

-Innovation & Creativity- being open to and actively pursuing novel ideas and new approaches.

-Initiative & Bias for Action- being proactive and persistent; being ready to act on opportunity.

-Resilience- perseverance and diligence in the face of setbacks.

-Achievement Drive- having high personal and professional standards, and striving to improve or meet new, higher standards **of excellence; continuously learning.**

-Stress Management- working calmly under stress and pressure.

-Realistic Optimism- expecting success rather than failure, seeing an opportunity rather than a threat; seeing others positively; expecting the future to bring positive change, that things will be better.

-Intentionality- thinking and acting on purpose and deliberately; knowing what it takes to control your own outcomes, your own destiny.

c. Other Awareness:

-Empathy- sensing others' feelings and perspectives, and taking an active interest in their concerns; the ability to put yourself in another's place and to take that perspective into account in your relationship with the other person.

-Service Ethic- anticipating, recognizing, and meeting customers' needs.

-Organizational Awareness- reading social and political currents in organizations, on teams, in their businesses, their communities, their schools, and their neighborhoods.

d. Relationship Management:

-Developing others- sensing other people's developmental needs and bolstering their abilities.

-Powerful Influence- wielding effective tactics for persuasion.

-Communication- listening deeply and openly and sending clear, credible, convincing messages.

-Conflict Management- effectively negotiating and resolving disagreements.

-Visionary Leadership- inspiring, guiding and mobilizing individuals and groups; articulating a clear compelling and motivating vision for the future.

-Catalyzing Change- initiating, managing and leading change.

-Building Bonds- nurturing and maintaining relationships, cultivating a wide network; connecting with others on a deeper rather than a superficial level.

-Teamwork & Collaboration- working with others toward shared goals; creating group synergy in the pursuit of collective goals.

-Building Trust- being trustworthy and ethical when working and relating to others; ability to establish a bond of trust with others.

B. Emotional Intelligence: So What?

1. Results of improved EI: *Research suggest that emotional intelligence can result in increased profitability, better retention of top performers, more successful recruitment and greater productivity.*
2. Mental/Emotional/Physical Outcomes: Specific Emotions Considered.
 - a. Anger – *those people who are quick to anger have double the chance of a heart attack if they are healthy. If they have an existing heart disease, they are 7 times more likely to risk a cardiac event.*
 - b. Hostility – *those with high scores are five times more likely to have a heart disease and more than five times the death rate.*
 - c. Anxiety – *the risk of heart disease is two to seven times higher in people with high levels of anxiety compared with people having lower anxiety.*
 - d. Stress – *people who live with very high levels of stress are four and a half times more likely to die from a heart attack or stroke than those who are not living with constant stress.*

III. Principles of Emotional Maturity for Growth (Peter Scazzero)

Principle 1: Look Beneath the Surface: *In emotionally healthy churches, people take a deep, hard look inside their hearts, asking, what is going on that Jesus Christ is trying to change? They understand that a person's life is like an iceberg, with the vast majority of who we are laying deep beneath the surface. They invite God to bring to their awareness and to transform those aspects beneath the surface layers that hinder them from becoming more like Jesus Christ.*

A. Real Change requires an inside look.

1. Matthew 23:25-26...
2. Quote: *An honest look at problems creates struggles that have more hope of leading to deep change than does a complacency supported by denial. Larry Crabb*

B. Looking beneath the surface components.

1. Developing an awareness of what I am feeling and doing.

- a. Jesus example of this in the text.
 - b. John 2:23-24..Jesus is not entrusting himself to some who claimed to believe.
 - b. Jesus consistently attempted to take the 12 below the surface in order to train them from the inside out.
2. Asking the “why” or “what’s going on” questions.
Discerning core **motivations and the condition of the heart.**
 3. Linking the Gospel and Emotional Health.
 - a. Isa. 62:5...
 - b. The Gospel= I am loved and accepted through Christ, therefore I obey.
 4. Getting rid of the “Glittering Image”.
 - See yourself for who you really are In Christ.
 - Renounce deception in your life,

C. Discipleship that leads to Personal & Relational Transformation.

1. Personal Transformation.
 - a. Sanctification (Hebrews 10:10-14)
 - 10:10-have been made holy
Positional sanctification
 - 10:14-those who are being made holy
Progressive Sanctification
 - b. Teleios = the developmental process of coming to wholeness or completeness, usually translated as “mature.”
 - Col. 1:28-to present each perfect
 - Heb. 5:14-solid food is for the mature
 - I John 2:5-God’s Word made complete in us

c. Boundary Markers versus Transformation.
Any action or the elimination of that gives one a false sense of transformation.

d. The process of Personal Transformation.

1) Identify wrong thinking/feelings Rom. 12:2

2) Confess and acknowledge wrong thinking I Jn. 1:9

3) Identify right thinking (truth) Rom. 12:2

4) Repentance, Holy Spirit empowered I Thess 1:9

5) Obedience

e. Renewing the Mind Process – Romans 12:2

ABCD – Analysis:

A-Activating Event B-Belief C- Consequential Feelings D- Decisive Behavior

If I don't like how I am feeling or behaving, I need to go back and examine B before the Lord. Rom. 12:2 to renew my mind will lead to transformation.

2. Relational Transformation.

a. Paraklesis = draw near to provide comfort, exhortation, counsel or encouragement to another.

1) II Cor. 1:3-4...

2) Acts 13:15...

3) Hebrews 3:13...

b. Relational Balance.

1) Eccl. 4:12... a cord of 3 strands cannot be easily broken

2) Matt. 22:36-39

Other's

God

Self

Stay centered with Love for God. Take all orders from Him as to what you do for others and what is for you in life. He will keep the balance.

D. Jesus Invites Us to Embrace Healing Surgery.

Luke 13:1-9

1. God's Call to Repentance.

Luke 13: 1-5

a. Temptation to excuse ourselves through comparison.

b. Exhortation to own our stuff.

2 .Ingredients of Change and healing...In Redemptive Time.

Luke 13: 6-9

a. Hearing from Jesus – Parable re-write.

A man (God the Father) had a fig tree (your name) planted in His vineyard, and He (God the Father) went to look for fruit on it (from your life) and did not find any.

So, He (God the Father) said to the man (Jesus) who took care of the vineyard, for three years now (normal time for fig trees to produce) I've been coming to look for fruit on this tree (your name) and have not found any. Cut it down! Why should it use up the soil? said the man (God the Father).

Sir (God the Father), the man (Jesus) replied, leave it alone for one more year (redemptive time) I'll dig around it (apply God's truth) and fertilize it (grace filled relationship).

If it (your name) bears fruit next year, fine. If not, then cut it down (unbeliever perishing in Hell, believer perish in the sense of life falling apart in conflict and confusion).

b. Exercise: Lectio Divinia

Select a portion of scripture and have it read 3 times, listen for the following focus as it is read. Then share that in your Group.

-1st reading: Listen for what word or phrase stands out

-2nd reading: What are you feeling as it is read?

-3rd reading: What do you think God is saying for you to?
Do?

Pray together about the things shared in the 3rd question in this prayer group!!

This becomes a relational or heart interaction around the Word, together.

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Grace/Truth/Redemptive Time explained.

(Referenced from *Changes that Heal*, Henry Cloud)

- e. Truth = truth is what is real. It describes how things really are. It keeps us from falling into the same patterns over and over again. It is God's truth as revealed in His Word and through the Holy Spirit.
- f. Grace = grace is unmerited favor from God and bestowed toward those who are or in the process of becoming His. Grace is that which we have not earned, nor can we ever earn, that which is totally undeserved.
- g. Redemptive Time = only through a combination of grace and truth is the real Jesus ever present. And only when the real Jesus is present can we begin to heal and grow into the likeness of our Creator.

e. Incarnate Jesus in Redemptive Time. John 1:14-18 this time becomes redemptive time in that it actively allows God to engage the ingredients of grace and truth through the incarnate work of Jesus Christ.

To the degree that your missional community is about:

-fostering an environment where there is enough grace in our relationships to speak/study/apply truth...

-doing so with an awareness of the redemptive time each of us needs for...

-moving forward into honest sharing, healing and growth from our Lord.

To have grace without truth =license

To have truth with grace = judgment, legalism, critical spirit

To have just time = stagnation or worsened situation

E. Three Dimensions of Transformation. (Dr. Jay Diller)

Transformation is that life changing process that the Holy Spirit works out in the life of a believer who is yielded to the work and leadership of God. It needs to be seen as a process and not an event. It is a process of mind renewal that comes about through the replacement of falsehood with God's truth. As the believer vulnerably opens their heart in safe community; emotional awareness begins to lead to discovery of emotions bound up due to those false beliefs. So, as the emotions become a window to the discovery of the wrong thinking, confession and repentance opens the door to mind renewal, freedom and transformation.

This process is understood better through the 3-dimensional approach that begins with a fresh encounter with God and the work of the Holy Spirit in the believer's life.

1. Dimension One - Upward Transformation: Humbled by the Holy Presence of God.

- a. Pursued by God... James 4:8
- b. Humbled by Holiness... Isa. 6:1-7

The Spirit of God, dwelling in us, given to us, to be as it were our own spirit, enables us to know and experience, in a mysterious manner, the reality and presence of the divine mercy in ourselves. So the Holy Spirit is intimately united to our own inmost self, and His presence in us makes our "I" the "I" of God.
(Robert Mulholland, *the Deeper Journey*)

2. Dimension Two – Inward Transformation: Changed from the Inside Out by the Entrance of God.

- a. Bringing the developing damage of sin above the water line.
(Dr. Gary Sweeten, *Listening for Heaven's Sake*)
 - 1) Rebellion: a transgression of a religious or moral law, especially when deliberate.

Inner Statement: I chose not to get life

Psm. 32: 5b...

II Timothy 3:2-4

Loss of Desire: Willful behavior, self-centeredness
And wicked desires

- 2) Guilt: a condition of estrangement from God as a result of breaking God's Law.

Inner Statement: There is a gulf between us and God

Psm. 32: 5c...

Romans 2:8...

Loss of Intimacy: True moral guilt, separation, justice, punishment

- 3) Shame: a condition of distorted internal judgment of oneself and one's self worth, which leads to hiding and not receiving from others.

Inner Statement: I have lost my sense of identity

Psm. 32:3...

Proverbs 14:10...

- 4) Bondage: persistent accumulation of rebellion, guilt and shame which eventually leads to a weakened and destroyed ability to initiate healthy change.

Inner Statement: I could never get life

Psm. 32:4...

Romans 7...

You can see how all four aspects of sin combine to perpetuate a cycle of despair and dysfunction. They are also closely interrelated. Because I am born into sin, I have an innate tendency toward rebellion. When I rebel, my guilt estranges me from God. I feel ashamed and hide. As sin tightens its grip, I discover that I'm unable to initiate healthy change. In other words, I'm caught in deeper bondage and the cycle continues.
(Dr. Gary Sweeten, *Listening for Heaven's Sake*)

b. Grace applied to the cycle of sin.

Through the Cross of Christ, we have a remedy for the problem of sin. The cycle of grace summarizes the application of grace to all four aspects of sin's development. This applies to all people. (Dr. Gary Sweeten)

1) For Rebellion: Invitation – Return

Luke 15: 17-20, John 7:37-38

2) For Guilt: Forgiveness – Restore

I John 1:8-9, Acts 2:38-39

3) For Shame: Truth – Renew

Gal. 4:7, Romans 12:2

4) For Bondage: Power – Redemption

II Cor. 10:3-5...

3. Dimension Three: Outward Transformation: Compelled to walk with pre-follower's into the presence of God through authentic relationships.

The church is God's primary instrument for communicating the Good News. The church is God's missionary to the world. There is nothing more important

related to fulfilling the Great Commandment than a church which understands that this commission is central to its mission, has created an environment that welcomes outsiders into this mission, and deploys insiders in fulfilling this mission. This becomes very evident in the first century church.

With this in mind, the church must become a safe place for people to experiment with and experience different aspects of the Christian faith. As such, followers of Christ must have a heart for engaging and loving people of different values, experiences and worldviews. They must also be equipped to engage people who are both far away and near to God. When followers of Christ are able to hear and have understanding of how to love and engage those on the outside, along with a safe place for people to experiment with the Christian faith, life change becomes part of the culture.

Ed Stetzer, Breaking the Missional Code

Discussion:

1. What happens when each one of the three dimensions turn up missing in a follower's life? Consider each one at a time.

-Upward:

-Inward:

-Outward:

2. What happens to a local church gathering of the church when each one of the 3-dimensions turns up missing? Consider each one at a time.

-Upward:

-Inward:

-Outward:

Principle 2: Breaking the Power of the Past

In emotionally healthy churches, people understand how their past affects their present ability to love Christ and others. They've realized from scripture and life that an intricate, complex relationship exists between the kind of person they are today and their past. Numerous external forces may shape us, but the family we have grown up in is the primary and, except in rare instances, the most powerful system that will shape and influence who we are.

A. Making Peace with your past.

*In your passage through life, you want to be fully in charge of the route, the events, and the destination; in order to do so; you need a clear view of where you have been. Dr. Norman Wright, *Making Peace with Your Past*.*

1. It is then that we come to realize more fully that we can't do our life and recovery but **must come to totally depend on God** for it.

-Romans 15:13...

-Isa. 50:10-11...

2. 8 Recovery Principles from the Beatitudes.
(Rick Warren and John Baker, *Celebrate Recovery*)

R = realize I'm not God. I admit that I am powerless to control my tendency to do the wrong thing and that my life is unmanageable.

E = earnestly believe that God exists, that I matter to Him, and that He has the power to help me recover.

C = consciously choose to commit all my life and will to Christ's care and control.

O = openly examine and confess my faults to myself, to God, and to someone I trust.

V = voluntarily submit to every change God wants to make in my life and humbly ask Him to remove my character defects.

E = evaluate all my relationships. Offer forgiveness to those who have hurt me and make amends for harm I've done to others, except when to do so would harm them or others.

R = reserve a daily time with God for self-examination, Bible reading, and prayer in order to know God and His will for my life and to gain the power to follow His will.

Y = yield myself to God to be used to bring this Good News to others, both by my example and by my words.

B. Growing Up Emotionally: Coming Home Again in Order to Leave Well.

*Going home again can help you to finally really leave home, which means growing up emotionally. When you can be yourself in the difficult setting of your family of origin, you **can be yourself anywhere**, and you will be better able to deal with current relationship problems in a flexible and appropriate way.*

Donald Richardson, the Inner Child Within

*When I was young, I **set out to change the world...***

*When I grew a little older, I perceived that this was too ambitious, so I set out to change my **state**.*

This too, I realized as I grew older was too ambitious, so I set out to change my town.

*When I realized I could not even do this, I tried to change my **family**.*

*Now as an old man, I know that I **should have started by changing myself**.*

*If I started with **myself**, maybe then I would have succeeded in changing my **family**, the **town**, or even the **state**...and who knows, maybe even **n the World**.*

(Words of a classic rabbi on this deathbed)

show up??? **Consider:** In your current ministry, **did one of your family members**
(Different body and name)

1. Survival Skills:

- a. What **survival skills** have you developed from your **early life and family of origin?**
- b. How successful have you been at **putting these child-like survival skills behind you?**

2. **Dysfunctional Family Roles.** Each are trying to manage the family stress for the family system, or at least attempts to lessen its impact.
 - a. **Enabler:** Usually the spouse, who seeks to take responsibility for meeting the family's needs.
 - b. **Family Hero:** Usually the oldest child, who tries to make things better for the family, often taking responsibility for younger siblings, often becomes the non-drinking or non-acting out parent's confidant.
 - c. **Scapegoat:** Acts out the family's stress, gets into trouble and often distracts attention from the family problem.
 - d. **Mascot:** Interjects humor into painful situations as an attempt to distract from the acting out problem in the family.
 - e. **Lost Child:** Covers up feelings and tries to be the one person who the family does not need to worry about.

Roles such as these keep the family going, but they also can support the dysfunctional parent in their dysfunctional behaviors.

As long as the family seems to be getting along, there is less motivation to change. The family, therefore, is caught in a trap where winning is impossible. If they adjust to the dysfunctional person, the problem is perpetuated and pain goes on. If the family doesn't adjust, everyone is hurt and the pain continues.

3. **5 Rules of an Addict or Dysfunctional Family.** These rules manage to keep the family from reaching towards or from

being exposed to healthy interactions. They keep the family unhealthy or dysfunctional.

- a. **Do not talk...**so the real problems never get discussed, therefore no outside of the family help = secrets of the family.
- b. **Do not feel...**learned not to with the family, not safe to feel, taught not to and that it only gets you into trouble.
- c. **Do not trust...**learned not to trust in the family so I now do the same in other relationships
- d. **Do not rock the boat...**keep things smooth, don't address problems. So not good things don't have much of a chance of becoming good things.

4. Two Kinds of Family Rules:

- a. **Spoken:** The easier rules that include things like, don't talk while you have food in your mouth.
- b. **Unspoken:** they may be understood and even agreed upon by family, but they are not openly addressed.

Examples:

- 1) When things don't go your way, you can be angry, but you can't get depressed.
- 2) When men in this family feel afraid, they are supposed to deny these feelings.
- 3) Always appear happy and keep a stiff upper lip.

Reflections:

LE7547 Notes

1. What were some of the unspoken rules in your family of origin which were designed to keep you from expressing and eventually...being unaware of feelings?
2. What happened to the level of anxiety in your family of origin when unspoken rules were broken?
3. What unspoken rules are you still observing in other relationship in life and ministry...and how do you still react?

Recommendation: Read and journal your way through the book, *Released from Shame*, by Sandra Wilson.

PPT: Dan Allendar, *To Be Told*, read over this and learn the summary.

C. Taking Charge of Your Attitudes through the Gospel.

Matthew 6 – Jesus asks us to pray in v.10A...*Your Kingdom come, Father God.* Jesus is asking us to pray: **May the rule and reign of Christ be true in me now.**

As followers of Jesus Christ, we have access to all the accomplishments and the power of the Gospel. The question is moment by moment: will we:

-Choose to live in the reality of our Identity in Christ?

-Choose to live **under the power of the Gospel?**

We often fail to make the choices identified. Two usual alternatives that lead to a failure to take charge of our attitudes, or make choices that demonstrate our choice to not live under all the provisions of the Gospel.

1. Blame = the **reaction of an aggressive attitude**

Only one kind of person is relatively hopeless...that person who blames others for his or her problems. If you can own the mess you are in, there is hope for you and help available. As long as you blame others; you will be a victim for the rest of your life.

Bruce Larson

Blame never affirms, it assaults. Blame never restores, it wounds. Blame never solves, it complicates. Blame never unites, it separates. Blame never smiles, it frowns. Blame never forgets, it rejects. Blame never builds, it destroys.

Charles Swindoll

Why does blame fail in helping us take charge of our attitudes and consequential behaviors?

Keeps us in victim, not victory.

2. Self Pity = the reaction of a passive attitude

A mindset that says, I am a victim in life, life is so unfair, or I am helpless to deal with the blows life deals me. God must not care or love me after all. God has lost my address.

Why does self pity fail in helping us take charge of our attitudes and consequential behaviors?

Exercise: Read Acts 16:22-40

1. What do you observe about Peter and Silas's the glory life attitudes, especially those pertaining to blame and self-pity.
2. If blame and self-pity were used, what would the situation look like instead of the picture absent of blame and self-pity?

D. Failure to Claim Our Freedom through Christ.

1. Giving Ground to Satan.

Evaluate: How we give ground to Satan:

- a. Who do you hate? How far from forgiveness are you?
II Cor. 2:10-11
- b. How have you excused yourself to sin because of anger?

Eph. 4:26-27

- c. Do you have on the girdle of truth? (Question of complete honesty in one life).

Eph. 6

- d. Do you allow Satan to implant thoughts when the chips are down or do you continue to believe God's promises by faith?

Rev. 12:10

- e. Do you allow Satan to speak his words though you?

Proverbs 6:2

2. Daily Prayer: Claiming Our Freedom through Jesus.

My dear Lord Jesus, I come to you now to be restored I you—to renew my place in you, my allegiance to you, and to receive from you all the grace and mercy I so desperately need this day. I honor you as my sovereign Lord, and I **surrender every aspect of my life totally and completely to you.** I give you my body as a living sacrifice. I give you my soul and my spirit as well. I **cover myself with your blood**—my spirit, my soul and my body.

I ask your Holy Spirit to **restore my union with you**, seal me in your and guide me in this time of prayer. In all that I now pray, I include (my wife and children by name). Acting as their Head, I bring them **under my authority and covering, and I come under your authority and covering.** Holy Spirit, apply to them all that I now pray on their behalf.

Dear God, holy and blessed Trinity, you alone are **worthy of all my worship**, my heart's devotion, all my praise and all my trust and all the glory of my life. I worship you, bow to you, and give myself over to you in my heart's search for life. **You alone are Life,** and you have become my life. I renounce all other gods, all idols, and I give you the place in my heart and in my life that you truly deserve. I confess here and now that it is **all about you, God, and not about me.** **You are the Hero of this story, and I belong to you.** **God forgive me, God, for my every sin. Search me and know me and** reveal to me any aspect of my life that is not pleasing to you. And grant me the grace of a **deep and true repentance.**

Heavenly Father, thank you for loving me and choosing me before you made the world. You are my true Father-my Creator, my Redeemer, my Sustainer, and the true end of all things, **including my life.** **I love you, I worship you.** **Thanks you for proving** your love for me by sending your only Son, Jesus to be my substitute and representative. I receive Him and all his life and all His work, which you ordained for me. Thank you for including me in Christ, for forgiving my sins, for granting me His righteousness, for

making me complete in Him. Thank you for making me alive in Christ, raising me with Him, seating me with Him at your right hand, granting me His authority and anointing me with your Holy Spirit. I receive it all with thanks and give it total claim to my life.

(Notice the specific references to the Finished Work of Christ)

Jesus, thank you for coming for me, for ransoming me with your own life. I honor you as my Lord, I love you, worship you, trust you. I sincerely receive you as my redemption, and I receive all the work and triumph of your crucifixion, whereby I am cleansed from all sin through your shed blood, my old nature is removed, my heart circumcised unto God. I take my place in your cross and death, whereby I have died with you to sin, to the flesh, to the world and to the evil one. I am crucified with Christ; I take my cross and crucify my flesh with all its pride, unbelief idolatry. I put off the old man. I bring the cross of Christ between me and all people, all spirits, all things. Holy Spirit, apply to (my wife and children) the fullness of the work of the crucifixion of Jesus Christ for me. I receive it with thanks and give it total claim to my life.

Jesus, I also sincerely receive you as my new life, my holiness and sanctification, and I receive all the work and triumph of your resurrection, whereby I have been raised with you to a new life, to walk in newness of life, dead to sin and alive to God. I am crucified with Christ and it is no longer I who live but Christ who lives in me. I take my place in your resurrection, putting on the new man in all holiness and humility, in all righteousness and purity and truth. Christ is now my life, the One who strengthens me. Holy Spirit, apply to me (my wife and my children) the fullness of the resurrection of Jesus Christ for me, I receive it with thanks and give it total claim in my life.

Jesus, I sincerely receive you as my everlasting deliverance from and victory over Satan, and I receive all the work and triumph of your ascension, whereby I have been raised with you to the right hand of the Father and established with you in all authority. I take my place in your ascension, whereby I am given fullness in you, in your power, authority, and dominion over every ruler, power, authority, and spiritual forces of wickedness. I claim the cross and blood of Jesus Christ against Satan, against his kingdom, and against all his emissaries and all their work against me and my domain. Satan is defeated, the prince of this world is cast down, the rules and authorities are disarmed. Greater is He who is in me than he who is in the world. Christ has given me authority to overcome all the power of the evil one and I claim that authority now over and against every enemy. Holy Spirit, apply to me (my wife and children) the fullness of the work of the ascension of Jesus Christ for me. I receive it with thanks and give it total claim to my life.

Holy Spirit, I sincerely receive you as my Counselor, my Comforter, my strength and my guide. Thanks for sealing me in Christ. I ask you to lead me into all truth, to anoint me for all of my life and walk and calling, and to lead me deeper into Jesus today. Apply to me, blessed Holy Spirit, all of the works and all the gifts in Pentecost. I fully open my life to you in every dimension and aspect, choosing to be filled with you, to walk in step with you in all things. Fill me afresh, blessed Holy Spirit. I receive you with thanks and give you total claim to my life (and my wife and children).

Dear Heavenly Father, thank you for granting me all spiritual blessings in the heavens in Christ Jesus. I receive those blessings into my life today, and I ask the Holy

Spirit to bring all those blessings into my life this day. Thank you for the blood of Jesus. Wash me with His blood from every sin and stain and evil device. Equip me with your armor: the belt of truth, the breastplate of righteousness, the shoes of the Gospel, the helmet of salvation. I take up the shield of faith and the sword of the Spirit, the word of God, and I wield these weapons against the evil one in the power of God. I choose to pray at all times in the Spirit.

Heavenly Father, thank you for your angels. I summon them in the authority of Jesus Christ and release them to war for me and my household. Thank you for the intercessors; I ask you to send forth your Spirit and raise them up, arouse them, unite them, establish and direct them, raising up the full canopy of prayer and intercession for me. I call forth the kingdom of the Lord Jesus Christ this day throughout my home, my family and my life.

All of this I pray in the Name of Jesus Christ, with all glory and honor and thanks to Him.

Prayer adapted by Dr. John Eldredge, from Ed Murphy's *The Spiritual Warfare Handbook*

E. Forgiveness: The Release Towards Rebuilding...Ephesians 4:31-32

1. Resentment's Expressions...4:31

a. Faces of resentment:

(Internal)

- 1) Bitterness: *brooding grudge-filled attitude*
- 2) Wrath: *wild intense inner rage, the passion of the moment*
- 3) Anger: *more subtle inner upset, sullen hostility*

(External)

- 4) Clamor: *shout of strife, reflects the public outbursts, loss of control*
- 5) Slander: *ongoing character assignation of another, rising from an inner root of bitterness.*
- 6) Malice: *any of the above, alternating*

2. Resentment's Release...4:31-32

Remember: Forgiveness deals with your pain, not another's behavior. Positive feelings will follow forgiveness, when given enough time.

a. Letting go of the past...4:31b

(Primary versus secondary emotions)

Past History

-Activating Event: dropped one of Dad's tools and he yelled at you in rage

-Primary Emotion: fear and anxiety

-Mental Evaluation: I never do anything right when I am working with Dad

-Secondary Emotion: sad, depressed, anger

b. Resolving your past offenses.

1) Live in light of present realities, not past offenses.

Remembering who you are in Christ

2) Forgive those who have offended you.

WHY?

-Required by God, Mt. 6:14-15, 18: 21-35

-Necessary to avoid entrapment by Satan II Cor. 2:11

-Standard operation for the believer, Eph. 4:31, 32

WHAT?

- Forgiveness is not...forgetting

- Forgiveness doesn't mean you must...tolerate sin

▪ Forgiveness doesn't demand ...revenge or repayment for offenses suffered

- Forgiveness means resolving to live with the...consequences of another's sin

HOW? *(Adapted from Dr. Neil Anderson seminar material)*

a. Preparation for forgiveness:

- 1) Acknowledge the hurt and the resentment
- 2) Let God bring the pain to the surface so He can deal with it
- 3) Don't wait to forgive until you feel like it.

b. 7 Steps toward forgiveness of others:

- 1) Choose to forgive that person, specifically.
- 2) Ask God to forgive that person.
- 3) Ask God to forgive you for holding resentment and un-forgiveness in your heart towards them.
- 4) You forgive God for allowing this person to hurt you.
- 5) Appropriately ventilate stored up emotions.
- 6) Request for God to pour His healing balm called thanksgiving over your hurts. Also, to fill you with His love and presence.
- 7) Ask God to bless the offender in every way possible.

Principle 3: Live in Brokenness and Vulnerability:

*In emotional healthy churches, people **live** and **lead** out of brokenness and vulnerability. They understand that leadership in the kingdom of God is from the bottom up, not a grasping, controlling, or lording over others. It is **leading out of failure and pain, questions and struggles---a serving that lets go**. It is a noticeably different way of life from what is commonly modeled in the world and **unfortunately, in many churches.***

Peter Scazzero

A. Develop a Theology of Weakness.

1. **Broken in order to seek Him.** God released the curse in order **to drive us to our knees and to Him**; in that place where we seek Him wholeheartedly.
2. **Seeking God with your whole heart...** Jer. 29:14:

B. Accepting your gift of a handicap.

-Makes you **aware of your dependency on God.**

- What is your thorn in the flesh?

C. Transitioning to a **church based on weakness.**

1. Modeling transparency out of healthy personal discovery.
-This is not doing personal therapy from the pulpit.
2. Admitting the truth about you through the skill of self-disclosure.
Share a brief aspect of your life and learning, then immediately bring it back to their life and the potential application in their lives

D. Following the Prodigal Son as the Model. (*Scazzero*)

1. Younger brother –knowing you own neediness
2. Older brother –picture of lostness
3. How do I know if I am the older brother?
 - Hold onto anger rather than process it honestly
 - Find myself grumbling and complaining lots
 - Struggle to let go of offenses
4. becoming like the Father. (Quote pp 130-131)

Principle 4: Receive the Gift of Limits. (Scazzero)

Emotionally healthy people understand the limits God has given them. They joyfully receive the one, two, seven or ten talents God has so graciously distributed. As a result, they are not frenzied and covetous, trying to live a life God never intended. They are marked by contentment and joy.

Emotionally healthy churches also embrace their limits with the same joy and contentment, not attempting to be like another church. They have a confident sense of God's good hand on their church for such a time as this.

Esther 4:11-14:

A. Overcoming Unhealthy Helping.

Galatians 6:2-5...

-6:2: baros...bear one another's burdens. This is more than you could bear on your own.

-6:5: phortion...each of you carry your own load. That, which is your God-given responsibility to deal with on your own. (Mt. 18 example)

B. Questioning the church without limits.

-Numerical growth all the time, may not be God's will

-Instead, make sure you are equipping and releasing in a healthy balance

-Not over working, allowing unhealthy helping

C. Recognizing that Jesus Embraced Human Limits...Matt. 4

Temptations of Jesus to guard against in our lives:

7. Tempted to go beyond the Father's limits around His life.
Turning stones into bread
Jesus embraced the limits, answers with scripture
8. Tempted to do something sensational and **prove Himself to everyone**.
Jump off of a tall building
Jesus walks down normally and ignores Satan, **answers with scripture**
9. Tempted to bow to Satan briefly and Satan would bless Him.
Bow to Satan and have all His earthly kingdoms
Jesus embraces the suffering of the Cross, answers with scripture

C. Learning to **discern my limitations**.

1. Know yourself, your personality.
 - Disc Profile
 - What **gives or drains you of energy, etc.**
2. Realistically **evaluate your season of life**.
Ecc. 3:1-3 season for everything
Is this the stage of raising small children, for example
3. Assess your **emotional, physical and intellectual capacities**.

Maturity= living joyfully within your **God-given limits**
Access this accurately or suffer burnout
4. Get **honest with your life situation**.
 - Sickness
 - Situation with children
 - Make room for being missional in your community
5. **Honestly own your negative emotions**.
 - Depression, anger
 - What is God trying to tell you??

6. Find the courage in Christ to look at your **unhealed scars and** wounds from your family past.

BOOK – *Released from Shame*, Sandra Wilson

D. Integrating the gift of limits into the church.

- Self care of leaders- set limits on invasive people
- Give people the freedom to say no
- Intentionally teach healthy boundaries

E. Watching God work through our limitations.

- Sometimes God take us beyond with the supernatural
- Other times it is a reality check-keeps us aware of our need of Him.

Principle 5: Embrace grieving and loss. (Scazzero)

In emotionally healthy churches, people embrace grief as a way to become more like God. They understand what a critical component of discipleship grieving our losses can be. Why? It is the only pathway to becoming a compassionate person like our Lord Jesus.

I covered over my losses for years and years, unaware of how they were shaping my current relationships and leadership. God was seeking to enlarge my soul and mature me, while I was seeking a quick end to my pain. He won.

What are the losses of your life???

A. Grieving: The Work of Mourning-Recovering from the losses of life.

1. Mourning is...the necessary process of returning back to life after we have been jolted from its road. It involves leaving behind what needs to be left behind, bringing along what needs to be brought along and learning to distinguish between the two.

2. Grieving is...daring in process to look at the full reality of your pain and loss, feeling deeply the pain, re-feeling it honestly as it returns again and again and slowly diminishing. Asking the tough questions of God, staying with Him long enough to know Him and His comfort, learning to trust Him to heal the hurt and move you onto that which He has next for you in life.

-John 11: 33-35...Jesus shows us the importance of grieving by doing it himself, even when he could have come earlier and kept his friend from dying.

B. Enlarging the “soul” through suffering.

Make more room for God and His compassion for others in your life

C. Let grief develop maturity.

-We learn our limits through the faithfulness of God and grief. This provides the raw material for growth

D. Avoid superficial forgiveness.

1. Phase One: Paying attention as part of the grieving process.

To the disappointment, all that is happening in the inner self. God is not in the habit of fixing that which is not broke.

2. Phase Two: Living in the confusion in between.

a. Example of the Psalms:

- 1) Songs of orientation...enjoy God and His creation
- 2) Songs of disorientation...hurt, suffering and dislocation

3) Songs of re-orientation...God breaks in and does a new thing

b. Grieving and discipleship.

1) Take the time to journal your losses.

2) Equip those who serve in your church to identify and reflect on losses in their lives and those they serve.

3) Teach the psalms to give people a biblical basis and framework for grieving.

4) Those you mentor, teach them to make a timeline of their lives from birth to the present.

-Jer. 29:11-14a

3. How do we grieve, doing the work of mourning?

a. Begin to acknowledge and face the pain of the loss.

b. Attempt to face the reality of the loss....

c. Begin to function in your new reality in light of...

d. Discover new directions for the emotional investment you once had in that which is now lost.

4. Why do we grieve?

a. Through grief you express your...feelings about your loss

- b. Through grief you express your protest at the loss as well as your desire to...change what happened and have it not be true
- c. Through grief you express the effects you have experienced from the...devastating impact of the loss
- d. The over all purpose of grief...to bring you to the point of making necessary changes so you can live with the loss in a healthy spiritual way.

The invitation of Christ to us. Matt. 11:28-30

Phase 3: Allowing the old to birth the new.

Grieving resolves the old, making it possible to renew, then to fully embrace the next

E. Allowing God the freedom to heal our infirmities...Romans 8:26-27.

1. God's Part:

Intercedes for us, according to His will
Searches out hearts

2. Our Enlisted Part:

- a. Face your problems squarely.

- b. Accept your responsibility in the matter.
- c. Ask yourself if you want to be healed.
John 5:1-6 example from Jesus
- d. Decide to forgive everyone who is involved in your hurt.
- e. Forgive yourself out of a true acceptance of God's forgiveness.
- f. Ask the Holy Spirit to show you what your real problem is and how you need to pray.

Principle 6: Make Incarnational Your Model for Loving Well. (Scazzero)

In emotionally healthy churches, people intentionally follow the model of Jesus. They learn to follow the 3 dynamics of incarnation found in the life of Jesus in order to love other people; enter another's world, holding on to yourself, and hanging between two worlds.

A. Two Voices/Messages to filter. (Henry Nouwen)

- 1. Succeed and achieve, go for it at all costs.
- 2. Goal of ministry is to recognize the Lord's voice, His face and His touch in every person you meet.

B. Dynamics of Incarnational Living. (Scazzero)

- 1. Entering another's World: *Learning to listen, to be present, not in a rush or distracted.*
- 2. Holding on to Yourself: *To hold on to yourselves and not to lose ourselves when we enter another person's world. Without this ability it is not possible to lead people to new places*

3. Hanging between 2 worlds: *When we choose to incarnate, we hang between our own world and the world of another person. We are called to remain faithful to who we are, not losing our essence, while at the same time entering into the world of another.*

C. Emerging Culture/ Missional Church.

1. Shaping the philosophy of ministry. *(Michael Frost)*

2. Attractional versus Missional.

D. Missional Church: Missional living is the Norm. *(Jeff Vanderstelt)*
(Elder Training Material)

1. Missional Living: Introduction and overview. John 20: 21, Acts 1:8, Matt. 28:18-20.
 - a. Because Jesus is the second Adam who came and lived life as we were meant to live it; He is our model of life.
 - b. In His life, we see how kingdom members are to live. Jesus makes it clear that He was sent by the Father to accomplish the work that He was given.

- c. He lived a missional life. Then, He gave us the mission of being witnesses of His Good News (The Gospel) and making disciples of all nations. He tells us that we are sent by Him just as He was sent by the Father.
2. Missional Living: Consider the challenge of John 14.
- a. Jesus was sent into a dark, broken, sinful world to display what God looks like among humanity.
 - b. He didn't expect people to climb a ladder to get to Him or behave appropriately before He loves them.
 - c. Instead, He dwelt among those who needed Him the most and in return He was called a sinner by the religious elite of His day.
 - d. **He calls us to the same thing!**
3. Missional Living: "Doing" that comes out of "being" in your community. John 13:34-35.
- a. We have been called to share the love and truth about God to a lost world and broken world.
 - b. We do this not by hiding out in a building and expecting people to just show up.
 - c. We do not live this out by expecting people to adopt our culture, speak our language and behave like us before they get to see and experience the Gospel.
 - d. We take this love and light of God into a hurting, dark world; we embody the grace and truth of God and dwell among people who need it.

Please answer these questions as honestly as possible.

Use the scoring method as indicated.

PART A: General Formation and Discipleship

- | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1. I feel confident of my adoption as God's son/daughter and rarely, if ever, question his acceptance of me. | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 2. I love to worship God by myself as well as with others. | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 3. I spend regular quality time in the Word of God and in prayer. | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 4. I sense the unique ways God has gifted me individually and am actively using my spiritual gifts for his service. | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 5. I am a vital participant in a community with other believers. | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 6. It is clear that my money, gifts, time, and abilities are completely at God's disposal and not my own. | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 7. I consistently integrate my faith in the marketplace and the world. | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |

TOTAL: _____

PART B: Emotional Components of Discipleship

Principle 1: Look beneath the Surface

- | | | | | |
|--|---|---|---|---|
| 1. It's easy for me to identify what I am feeling inside (Luke 19:41–44; John 11:33–35). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 2. I am willing to explore previously unknown or unacceptable parts of myself, allowing Christ to transform me more fully (Rom. 7:21–25; Col. 3:5–17). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 3. I enjoy being alone in quiet reflection with God and myself (Mark 1:35; Luke 6:12). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 4. I can share freely about my emotions, sexuality, joy, and pain (Ps. 22; Prov. 5:18–19; Luke 10:21). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 5. I am able to experience and deal with anger in a way that leads to growth in others and myself (Eph. 4:25–32). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 6. I am honest with myself (and a few significant others) about the feelings, beliefs, doubts, pains, and hurts beneath the surface of my life (Ps. 73; 88; Jer. 20:7–18). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |

TOTAL: _____

Principle 2: Break the Power of the Past

- | | | | | |
|--|---|---|---|---|
| 7. I resolve conflict in a clear, direct, and respectful way, not what I might have learned growing up in my family, such as painful putdowns, avoidance, escalating tensions, or going to a third party rather than to the person directly (Matt. 18:15–18). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 8. I am intentional at working through the impact of significant “earthquake” events that shaped my present, such as the death of a family member, an unexpected pregnancy, divorce, addiction, or major financial disaster (Gen. 50:20; Ps. 51). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 9. I am able to thank God for all my past life experiences, seeing how he has used them to uniquely shape me into who I am (Gen. 50:20; Rom. 8:28–30). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 10. I can see how certain “generational sins” have been passed down to me through my family history, including character flaws, lies, secrets, ways of coping with pain, and unhealthy tendencies in relating to others (Ex. 20:5; cf. Gen. 20:2; 26:7; 27:19; 37:1–33). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 11. I don't need approval from others to feel good about myself (Prov. 29:25; Gal. 1:10). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 12. I take responsibility and ownership for my past life rather than blame others (John 5:5–7). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |

TOTAL: _____

Principle 3: Live in Brokenness and Vulnerability

- | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 13. I often admit when I'm wrong, readily asking forgiveness from others (Matt. 5:23–24). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 14. I am able to speak freely about my weaknesses, failures, and mistakes (2 Cor. 12:7–12). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 15. Others would easily describe me as approachable, gentle, open, and transparent (Gal. 5:22–23; 1 Cor. 13:1–6). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 16. Those close to me would say that I am not easily offended or hurt (Matt. 5:39–42, 1 Cor. 13:5). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 17. I am consistently open to hearing and applying constructive criticism and feedback that others might have for me (Prov. 10:17; 17:10; 25:12). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 18. I am rarely judgmental or critical of others (Matt. 7:1–5). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 19. Others would say that I am slow to speak, quick to listen, and good at seeing things from their perspective (James 1:19–20). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |

TOTAL: _____

Principle 4: Receive the Gift of Limits

- | | | | | |
|--|---|---|---|---|
| 20. I've never been accused of "trying to do it all" or of biting off more than I could chew (Matt. 4:1–11). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 21. I am regularly able to say "no" to requests and opportunities rather than risk overextending myself (Mark 6:30–32). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 22. I recognize the different situations where my unique, God-given personality can be either a help or hindrance in responding appropriately (Ps. 139; Rom. 12:3; 1 Peter 4:10). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 23. It's easy for me to distinguish the difference between when to help carry someone else's burden (Gal 6:2) and when to let it go so they can carry their own burden (Gal. 6:5). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 24. I have a good sense of my emotional, relational, physical, and spiritual capacities, intentionally pulling back to rest and fill my "gas tank" again (Mark 1:21–39). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 25. Those close to me would say that I am good at balancing family, rest, work, and play in a biblical way (Ex. 20:8). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |

TOTAL: _____

Principle 5: Embrace Grieving and Loss

- | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 26. I openly admit my losses and disappointments (Ps. 3; 5). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 27. When I go through a disappointment or a loss, I reflect on how I'm feeling rather than pretend that nothing is wrong (2 Sam. 1:4, 17–27; Ps. 51:1–17). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 28. I take time to grieve my losses as David (Ps. 69) and Jesus did (Matt. 26:39; John 11:35; 12:27). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 29. People who are in great pain and sorrow tend to seek me out because it's clear to them that I am in touch with the losses and sorrows in my own life (2 Cor 1:3–7). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 30. I am able to cry and experience depression or sadness, explore the reasons behind it, and allow God to work in me through it (Ps. 42; Matt. 26:36–46). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |

TOTAL: _____

Principle 6: Make Incarnation Your Model for Loving Well

- | | | | | |
|--|---|---|---|---|
| 31. I am regularly able to enter into other people's world and feelings, connecting deeply with them and taking time to imagine what it feels like to live in their shoes (John 1:1–14; 2 Cor. 8:9; Phil. 2:3–5). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 32. People close to me would describe me as a responsive listener (Prov. 10:19; 29:11; James 1:19). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 33. When I confront someone who has hurt or wronged me, I speak more in the first person ("I" and "me") about how I am feeling rather than speak in blaming tones ("you" or "they") about what was done (Prov. 25:11; Eph. 4:29–32). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 34. I have little interest in judging other people or quickly giving opinions about them (Matt. 7:1–5). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 35. People would describe me as someone who makes "loving well" my number one aim (John 13:34–35; 1 Cor. 13). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |

TOTAL: _____

Principle 7: Slow Down to Lead with Integrity

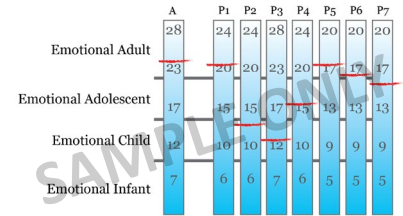
- | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 36. I spend sufficient time alone with God to sustain my work for God. | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 37. I regularly take a 24-hour period each week for Sabbath-keeping—to stop, to rest, to delight, and to contemplate God. | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 38. Those closest to me would say that my marriage and children take priority over church ministry and others. | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 39. I am not afraid to ask difficult, uncomfortable questions, to myself or to others, when needed. | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 40. I do not divide my leadership into sacred/secular categories. I treat the executive/planning functions of leadership as meaningful as prayer and preparing sermons. | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |

TOTAL: _____

INVENTORY RESULTS:

For each group of questions on previous pages:

- Add your answers to get the total for that group. Write your totals on the section below.
- Next, plot your answers and connect the dots to create a graph below similar to this sample ->
- Finally, see the next page for interpretations of your level of emotional health in each area. What patterns do you discern?



ASSESSMENT TOTALS:

Part A

General Formation and Discipleship

QUESTIONS	TOTAL
1 – 7	___ /28

Part B

Principle 1 – Look beneath the Surface

1 – 6 ___ /24

Principle 2 – Break the Power of the Past

7 – 12 ___ /24

Principle 3 – Live in Brokenness and Vulnerability

13 – 19 ___ /28

Principle 4 – Receive the Gift of Limits

20 – 25 ___ /24

Principle 5 – Embrace Grieving and Loss

26 – 30 ___ /20

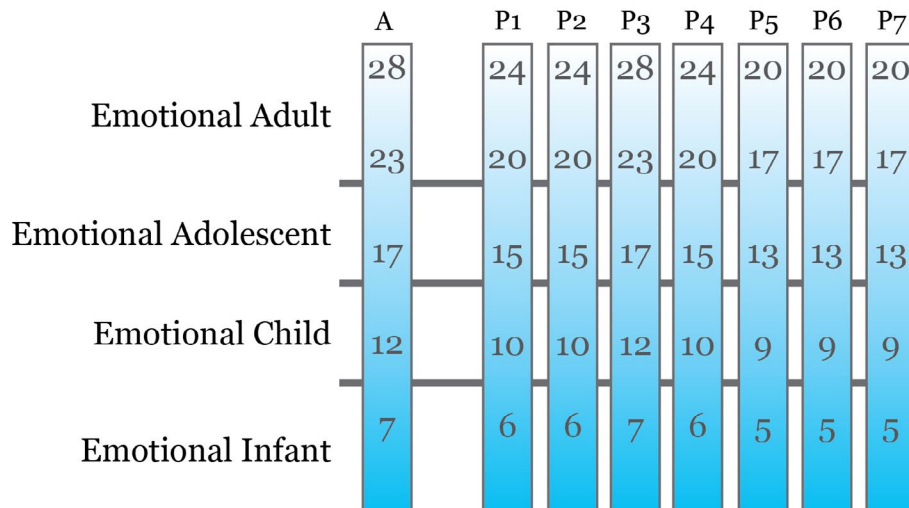
Principle 6 – Make Incarnation Your Model for Loving Well

31 – 35 ___ /20

Principle 7 – Slow Down to Lead with Integrity

36 – 40 ___ /20

GRAPH:



INTERPRETATION GUIDE: Levels of Emotional Maturity

Emotional Infant

I look for other people to take care of me emotionally and spiritually. I often have difficulty in describing and experiencing my feelings in healthy ways and rarely enter the emotional world of others. I am consistently driven by a need for instant gratification, often using others as objects to meet my needs. People sometimes perceive me as inconsiderate and insensitive. I am uncomfortable with silence or being alone. When trials, hardships, or difficulties come, I want to quit God and the Christian life. I sometimes experience God at church and when I am with other Christians, but rarely when I am at work or home.

Emotional Child

When life is going my way, I am content. However, as soon as disappointment or stress enter the picture, I quickly unravel inside. I often take things personally, interpreting disagreements or criticism as a personal offense. When I don't get my way, I often complain, throw an emotional tantrum, withdraw, manipulate, drag my feet, become sarcastic, or take revenge. I often end up living off the spirituality of other people because I am so overloaded and distracted. My prayer life is primarily talking to God, telling him what to do and how to fix my problems. Prayer is a duty, not a delight.

Emotional Adolescent

I don't like it when others question me. I often make quick judgments and interpretations of people's behavior. I withhold forgiveness to those who sin against me, avoiding or cutting them off when they do something to hurt me. I subconsciously keep records on the love I give out. I have trouble really listening to another person's pain, disappointments, or needs without becoming preoccupied with myself. I sometimes find myself too busy to spend adequate time nourishing my spiritual life. I attend church and serve others but enjoy few delights in Christ. My Christian life is still primarily about doing, not being with him. Prayer continues to be mostly me talking with little silence, solitude, or listening to God.

Emotional Adult

I respect and love others without having to change them or becoming judgmental. I value people for who they are, not for what they can give me or how they behave. I take responsibility for my own thoughts, feelings, goals, and actions. I can state my own beliefs and values to those who disagree with me — without becoming adversarial. I am able to accurately self-assess my limits, strengths, and weaknesses. I am deeply convinced that I am absolutely loved by Christ and, as a result, do not look to others to tell me I'm okay. I am able to integrate *doing* for God and *being* with him (Mary and Martha). My Christian life has moved beyond simply serving Christ to loving him and enjoying communion with him.

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EHS Personal Assessment



Please answer these questions as honestly as possible.
Use the scoring method as indicated.

PART A: General Formation and Discipleship

- | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1. I feel confident of my adoption as God's son/daughter and rarely, if ever, question his acceptance of me. | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 2. I love to worship God by myself as well as with others. | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 3. I spend regular quality time in the Word of God and in prayer. | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 4. I sense the unique ways God has gifted me individually and am actively using my spiritual gifts for his service. | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 5. I am a vital participant in a community with other believers. | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 6. It is clear that my money, gifts, time, and abilities are completely at God's disposal and not my own. | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 7. I consistently integrate my faith in the marketplace and the world. | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |

TOTAL _____

PART B: Emotional Components of Discipleship

Principle 1: Look beneath the Surface

- | | | | | |
|--|---|---|---|---|
| 1. It's easy for me to identify what I am feeling inside (Luke 19:41 – 44; John 11:33 – 35). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 2. I am willing to explore previously unknown or unacceptable parts of myself, allowing Christ to transform me more fully (Rom. 7:21 – 25; Col. 3:5 – 17). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 3. I enjoy being alone in quiet reflection with God and myself (Mark 1:35; Luke 6:12). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 4. I can share freely about my emotions, sexuality, joy, and pain (Ps. 22; Prov. 5:18 – 19; Luke 10:21). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 5. I am able to experience and deal with anger in a way that leads to growth in others and myself (Eph. 4:25 – 32). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 6. I am honest with myself (and a few significant others) about the feelings, beliefs, doubts, pains, and hurts beneath the surface of my life (Ps. 73; 88; Jer. 20:7 – 18). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |

TOTAL _____

Principle 2: Break the Power of the Past

- | | | | | |
|--|---|---|---|---|
| 7. I resolve conflict in a clear, direct, and respectful way, not what I might have learned growing up in my family, such as painful putdowns, avoidance, escalating tensions, or going to a third party rather than to the person directly (Matt. 18:15 – 18). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 8. I am intentional at working through the impact of significant "earthquake" events that shaped my present, such as the death of a family member, an unexpected pregnancy, divorce, addiction, or major financial disaster (Gen. 50:20; Ps. 51). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 9. I am able to thank God for all my past life experiences, seeing how he has used them to uniquely shape me into who I am (Gen. 50:20; Rom. 8:28 – 30). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 10. I can see how certain "generational sins" have been passed down to me through my family history, including character flaws, lies, secrets, ways of coping with pain, and unhealthy tendencies in relating to others (Ex. 20:5; cf. Gen. 20:2; 26:7; 27:19; 37:1 – 33). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 11. I don't need approval from others to feel good about myself (Prov. 29:25; Gal. 1:10). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 12. I take responsibility and ownership for my past life rather than blame others (John 5:5 – 7). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |

TOTAL _____

Principle 3: Live in Brokenness and Vulnerability

- | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 13. I often admit when I'm wrong, readily asking forgiveness from others (Matt. 5:23 – 24). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 14. I am able to speak freely about my weaknesses, failures, and mistakes (2 Cor. 12:7 – 12). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 15. Others would easily describe me as approachable, gentle, open, and transparent (Gal. 5:22 – 23; 1 Cor. 13:1 – 6). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 16. Those close to me would say that I am not easily offended or hurt (Matt. 5:39 – 42, 1 Cor. 13:5). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 17. I am consistently open to hearing and applying constructive criticism and feedback that others might have for me (Prov. 10:17; 17:10; 25:12). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 18. I am rarely judgmental or critical of others (Matt. 7:1 – 5). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 19. Others would say that I am slow to speak, quick to listen, and good at seeing things from their perspective (James 1:19 – 20). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |

TOTAL _____

Principle 4: Receive the Gift of Limits

- | | | | | |
|--|---|---|---|---|
| 20. I've never been accused of "trying to do it all" or of biting off more than I could chew (Matt. 4:1 – 11). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 21. I am regularly able to say "no" to requests and opportunities rather than risk overextending myself (Mark 6:30 – 32). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 22. I recognize the different situations where my unique, God-given personality can be either a help or hindrance in responding appropriately (Ps. 139; Rom. 12:3; 1 Peter 4:10). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 23. It's easy for me to distinguish the difference between when to help carry someone else's burden (Gal 6:2) and when to let it go so they can carry their own burden (Gal. 6:5). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 24. I have a good sense of my emotional, relational, physical, and spiritual capacities, intentionally pulling back to rest and fill my "gas tank" again (Mark 1:21 – 39). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 25. Those close to me would say that I am good at balancing family, rest, work, and play in a biblical way (Ex. 20:8). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |

TOTAL _____

Principle 5: Embrace Grieving and Loss

- | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 26. I openly admit my losses and disappointments (Ps. 3; 5). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 27. When I go through a disappointment or a loss, I reflect on how I'm feeling rather than pretend that nothing is wrong (2 Sam. 1:4, 17 – 27; Ps. 51:1 – 17). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 28. I take time to grieve my losses as David (Ps. 69) and Jesus did (Matt. 26:39; John 11:35; 12:27). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 29. People who are in great pain and sorrow tend to seek me out because it's clear to them that I am in touch with the losses and sorrows in my own life (2 Cor 1:3 – 7). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 30. I am able to cry and experience depression or sadness, explore the reasons behind it, and allow God to work in me through it (Ps. 42; Matt. 26:36 – 46). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |

TOTAL _____

Principle 6: Make Incarnation Your Model for Loving Well

- | | | | | |
|--|---|---|---|---|
| 31. I am regularly able to enter into other people's world and feelings, connecting deeply with them and taking time to imagine what it feels like to live in their shoes (John 1:1 – 14; 2 Cor. 8:9; Phil. 2:3 – 5). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 32. People close to me would describe me as a responsive listener (Prov. 10:19; 29:11; James 1:19). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 33. When I confront someone who has hurt or wronged me, I speak more in the first person ("I" and "me") about how I am feeling rather than speak in blaming tones ("you" or "they") about what was done (Prov. 25:11; Eph. 4:29 – 32). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 34. I have little interest in judging other people or quickly giving opinions about them (Matt. 7:1 – 5). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 35. People would describe me as someone who makes "loving well" my number one aim (John 13:34 – 35; 1 Cor. 13). | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |

TOTAL _____

Principle 7: Slow Down to Lead with Integrity

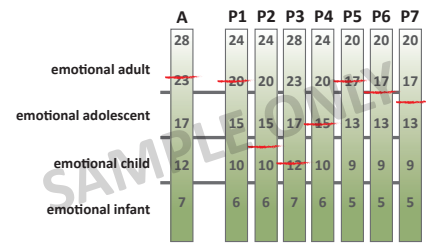
- | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 36. I spend sufficient time alone with God to sustain my work for God. | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 37. I regularly take a 24-hour period each week for Sabbath-keeping — to stop, to rest, to delight, and to contemplate God. | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 38. Those closest to me would say that my marriage and children take priority over church ministry and others. | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 39. I am not afraid to ask difficult, uncomfortable questions, to myself or to others, when needed. | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| 40. I do not divide my leadership into sacred/secular categories. I treat the executive/planning functions of leadership as meaningful as prayer and preparing sermons. | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |

TOTAL _____

INVENTORY RESULTS:

For each group of questions on previous pages:

- Add your answers to get the total for that group. Write your totals on the section below.
- Next, plot your answers and connect the dots to create a graph below similar to this sample:
- Finally, see the next page for interpretations of your level of emotional health in each area.
What patterns do you discern?



ASSESSMENT TOTALS:

Part A

General Formation and Discipleship

QUESTIONS TOTAL

1 – 7 ____/28

Part B

Principle 1 – Look beneath the Surface

1 – 6 ____/24

Principle 2 – Break the Power of the Past

7 – 12 ____/24

Principle 3 – Live in Brokenness and Vulnerability

13 – 19 ____/28

Principle 4 – Receive the Gift of Limits

20 – 25 ____/24

Principle 5 – Embrace Grieving and Loss

26 – 30 ____/20

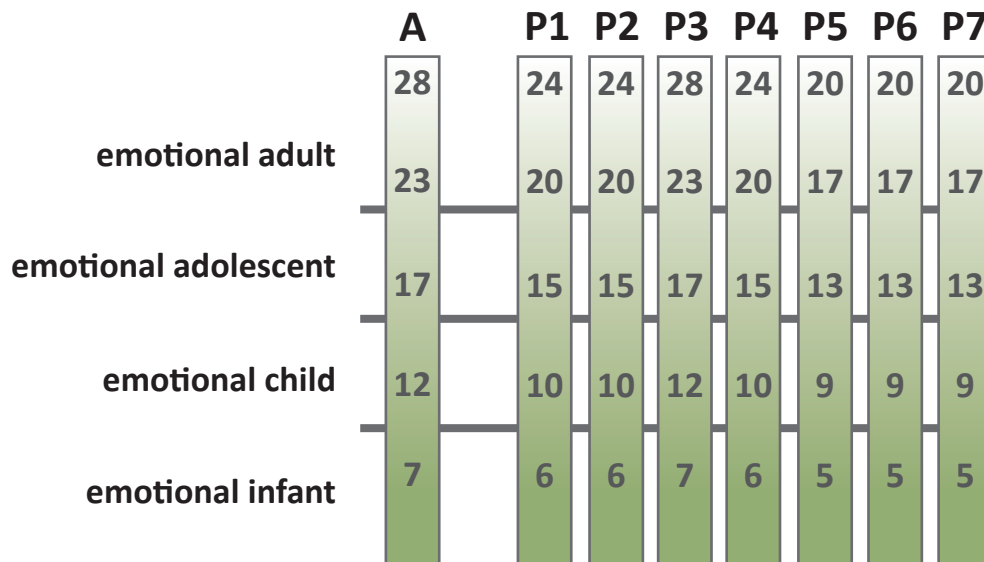
Principle 6 – Make Incarnation Your Model for Loving Well

31 – 35 ____/20

Principle 7 – Slow Down to Lead with Integrity

36 – 40 ____/20

GRAPH:



Interpretation Guide: Levels of Emotional Maturity

Emotional infant.

I look for other people to take care of me emotionally and spiritually. I often have difficulty in describing and experiencing my feelings in healthy ways and rarely enter the emotional world of others. I am consistently driven by a need for instant gratification, often using others as objects to meet my needs. People sometimes perceive me as inconsiderate and insensitive. I am uncomfortable with silence or being alone. When trials, hardships, or difficulties come, I want to quit God and the Christian life. I sometimes experience God at church and when I am with other Christians, but rarely when I am at work or home.

Emotional child.

When life is going my way, I am content. However, as soon as disappointment or stress enter the picture, I quickly unravel inside. I often take things personally, interpreting disagreements or criticism as a personal offense. When I don't get my way, I often complain, throw an emotional tantrum, withdraw, manipulate, drag my feet, become sarcastic, or take revenge. I often end up living off the spirituality of other people because I am so overloaded and distracted. My prayer life is primarily talking to God, telling him what to do and how to fix my problems. Prayer is a duty, not a delight.

Emotional adolescent.

I don't like it when others question me. I often make quick judgments and interpretations of people's behavior. I withhold forgiveness to those who sin against me, avoiding or cutting them off when they do something to hurt me. I subconsciously keep records on the love I give out. I have trouble really listening to another person's pain, disappointments, or needs without becoming preoccupied with myself. I sometimes find myself too busy to spend adequate time nourishing my spiritual life. I attend church and serve others but enjoy few delights in Christ. My Christian life is still primarily about doing, not being with him. Prayer continues to be mostly me talking with little silence, solitude, or listening to God.

Emotional adult.

I respect and love others without having to change them or becoming judgmental. I value people for who they are, not for what they can give me or how they behave. I take responsibility for my own thoughts, feelings, goals, and actions. I can state my own beliefs and values to those who disagree with me — without becoming adversarial. I am able to accurately self-assess my limits, strengths, and weaknesses. I am deeply convinced that I am absolutely loved by Christ and, as a result, do not look to others to tell me I'm okay. I am able to integrate doing for God and being with him (Mary and Martha). My Christian life has moved beyond simply serving Christ to loving him and enjoying communion with him.

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Waking the Dead **By Dr. John Eldredge**

- **Heart:**
- Your deepest thoughts, emotions, motives and passions...the deep you...
- The thoughts and intentions of the heart that shape a person's life. Proverbs. 23:7
- Where God hangs out in the believer. Ephesians 3:17
- Where we connect with God-a place of heart to heart, intimacy.

1

Intimacy

- We are in danger of placing efficiency over love, in our relationships, and even our relationship with God.
- "Christians have spent their whole lives mastering all sorts of principles, done their duty, carried on the programs of the church...and never known God intimately." Matt. 7:22-23
- The point is not activity, but intimacy with God.
- Logos: Written and Living- All about Jesus

2

Seeking with your whole heart

- "You will find me," God says, "when you seek me with all your heart." Jer. 29:13
- "To remain present to God, you must remain present to your heart. To hear His voice, you must listen with your heart. To love Him you must love with all your heart."
- We must live from the heart, the new heart.

3

Heart-continued

- New Covenant-2 parts: Ez. 36:26
- 1. New heart and spirit are given
- 2. Removes your heart of stone
- This is the reason Paul can say to us, "count yourselves dead to sin and alive to God in Christ Jesus." Rom. 6:1

4

Mission of Christ and your heart

- Jesus said, "God has sent me on a mission. I have some great news for you."
- God has sent me to restore and release something. And that something is you.
- I am here to give you back your heart and to set you free. (Paraphrase of Isa. 61:1)
- Free to participate in His Great Commission. Matt. 28:18-20.

5

But your enemy seeks to assault the heart

- Make you so busy doing good that you ignore your new heart.
- Wound you so deeply that you don't want a heart.
- Twist your theology so that you despise the heart.
- Without heart you cannot have life. Jn. 10:10

6

Ransomed Heart

- What has Christ done for our hearts?
- He ransomed your heart and gave you a new heart. Jer. 31:31-33
- Col. 2:11, made possible through Christ, Himself.
- Lk. 6:44-45, the good man brings forth good stored up in his good heart.
- Lk. 8:15, good soil stands for those with a noble and a good heart.

7

The miracle- able to live from your new heart.

- If we believed this truth... we could do anything. We would follow Jesus anywhere. It would change our lives.
- It is freedom, it is life.
- Imagine finding others willing to grow into this reality, together.
- Needing to process honestly through the 4 streams toward true missional community.

8

4 Streams

- 1. Discipleship:
- To be developed and mentored in the Lord and His Word to a place of learning:
- To hear from and walk with God in the process of one's days
- Learning to do this together in with the body of Christ gathered in community.

9

4 streams cont.-

- 2. Counseling:
- Telling our story in safe community till we begin to understand our story
- And how it interfaces with God's larger story.
- Encouraging each other to discover the glory He intends for each to discover and live out for His glory.

10

4 streams cont.-

- 3. Restorative Prayer:
- Safe community informed prayer for the
- Story teller
- that reaches out to the Lord for specific release and freedom available in Christ.
- A missional person on mission with Christ.

11

4 streams cont.-

- 4. Spiritual Warfare:
- Battling in community for each other in the authority of Christ,
- As we also find ourselves equipped to battle in victory.

12

Fellowship of the Heart

- **Safe authentic community that regularly lives out the 4 streams on behalf of those in the community...**
- **For the purpose of living out the life Christ offers and being equipped ..**
- **On mission for Christ.**

Principle 5: Embrace Grieving and Loss

- A. Grieving: The work of mourning-
- -John 11:33-35
- Who is to say which is more incredible:
- -Our God who raised the dead OR
- -Our God who weeps with us, then turns around and performs miracles

1

Cont-

- B. Enlarge the soul through suffering.
- -Making more room for God and His compassion for others.
- C. Let grief develop maturity.
- -We learn our limits through the faithfulness of God and grief. (Raw material for growth)

2

Cont-

- D. Avoid superficial forgiveness.
- 1. Phase One: Paying attention:
- -to the disappointment, all that is happening in the inner man.
- *"God is not in the habit of fixing that which is not broke."* Diller

3

Cont-

- Phase 2: Living in the confusion in between.
- a. Examples of the Psalms:
- 1) Songs of orientation...enjoy God & His creation.
- 2) Songs of disorientation...hurt, suffering and dislocation.
- 3) Songs of re-orientation...God breaking in and doing a new thing.

4

3. How do we grieve, doing the work of mourning?

- a. Begin to acknowledge and face the pain of the loss.
- -you don't attempt to postpone the pain.
- -you don't deny that it actually happened and you don't minimize your losses.

5

4. Why do we grieve?

- a. Through grief you express your...*feelings about your loss. PTSD Debriefing.*
- b. Through grief you express your protest at the loss as well as your desire to...*change what happened and have it not be true.*
- c. Through grief you express the effects you have experienced from the...*devastating impact of the loss.*

6

d. The overall purpose of grief...

- -to bring you to the point of making necessary changes, so that you can live with the loss in a healthy spiritual way.

Phase 3: Allowing the old to birth the new.

- Grieving resolves the old,, making it possible to renew...then to fully embrace the next.

7

E. Allowing God the freedom to heal our infirmities. Rom. 8:26-27

- 1. God's part.
- -Help us in our weaknesses.
- -Intercede for us, according to God's will
- Searches our hearts with the resources of the mind and the spirit.

8

The Emotionally Healthy Church, *by Peter Scazzero*

- Principle 4: Receive the Gift of Limits.
- *Emotionally healthy people understand the limits God has given them.*
- *They joyfully receive the 1,2,7, or 10 talents God has graciously distributed.*
- *As a result, they are not frenzied and covetous, trying to live a life God never intended.*

1

The illustration of the bridge and the rope

- Who do you most often represent ?
- A. The jumper at the end of his rope?
- *Taking on more than is wise and hoping someone will rescue you*
- B. The strong one on the bridge, holding a jumper's rope?
- Enabling others when they take on more than is wise

2

Author's testimony

- For years I pulled people up, often at great personal expense emotionally and spiritually,
- Only to find out they purposely would fall off (or jump off) another bridge,
- The next month.

3

Principle 4: Receive the Gift of Limits.

- A. Overcoming unhealthy helping.
- -6:2: Baros...bear one another's burdens
- *More than you could bear alone*
- -6:5: *Phortion...each one carry your own load.*
- *What is your God-given responsibility*
- -Matt. 18

4

B. Questioning the church without limits.

- -Numerical growth, all the time may not be God's will.
- *What is usually more important??*
- -Instead make sure you are equipping and releasing healthy disciples.
- -Not overworking or allowing unhealthy drivenness.

5

C. Recognizing that Jesus embraced human limits...Mt. 4

- 1. Tempted to go beyond the Father's limits around His life.
- -after 40 day fast, turn stones into bread.
- -Jesus embraces the limits and answers with scripture to silence the enemy.
- -ASK: What could this be in your life?
- When are you most tempted to take matter's into your own hands rather than trust God?
- Isa. 50:10-11

6

Cont-

- 2. Tempted to do something sensational and prove Himself to everyone.
- -To a tired man, jump off a tall building...short cut to the ground.
- -Jesus answers with scripture and walks down the normal way, ignoring the enemy.
- ASK: What is this for you??

7

Cont-

- 3. Tempted to bow to Satan briefly and Satan would bless Him.
- -instead of the coming suffering, bow to Satan and inherit his earthly kingdom.
- -Jesus embraces the suffering of the Cross and answers with scripture.
- ASK: How are you bowing to other idols instead of the sacrifices of obedience??

8

D. Learning to discern my limitations.

- 1. Know yourself, your personality.
- -DISC Profile
- -Do people energize or drain you?
- -Are into right and order, or not?
- 2. Realistically evaluate your season of life.
- -Eccl. 3:1-8...season for everything.
- -small children, older children in college

9

Cont-

- 3. Assess your emotional, physical and intellectual capacities.
- -maturity = living joyfully within your God-given limits.
- -assess accurately or burn-out
- 4. Get honest with your life situation.
- -cross-cultural stress-50% capacity
- -sickness, or handicap
- -make room for being missional in your area

10

Cont-

- 5. Honestly own your negative emotions.
- -What is God saying to you in them?
- -Depression could be anger turned on yourself.
- -Critical spirit could indicate unresolved anger
- 6. Find the courage in Christ to look at unhealed scars and wounds from your family past.
- BOOK: *Released from Shame*, by Sandra Wilson

11

E. Integrating the gift of limits into the church.

- -Self-care for leaders.
- -Set limits with invasive people.
- -Give people the freedom to say no.
- -Intentionally teach and model healthy boundaries.

12

F. Watching God work through our limitations.

- -Sometimes God takes us beyond, supernaturally.
- -Other times it is a reality check...
- Keeps us aware of our need for Him.

Principle 3: Live in Brokenness & Vulnerability

- A. Develop a theology of weakness.
- B. Accepting your gift of a handicap.
- -Makes you aware of your dependency on God.
- -What is your thorn in the flesh??

1

C. Transitioning to a church based on weakness.

- 1. Modeling transparency out of a healthy personal discovery.
- 2. Admitting the truth about you through the skill of self-disclosure.
- -Brief example from your life & learning...
- -then immediately bring it back to a potential application for their experience.
- James 5:16

2

D. Following the Prodigal Son as the Model.

- 1. Younger brother- knowing your neediness.
- 2. Older brother – picture of lostness.
- 3. How do I know if I am the older brother??
- -hold onto anger rather than process through it honestly

3

Cont-

- -find myself grumbling and complaining a significant amount of time.
- -struggle to let go of offenses.
- 4. Becoming like the Father.

4

Principle 2: Breaking the Power of the Past

- ▣ A. Making peace with your past.

8 recovery principles from CR

- ▣ R-realize I'm not God.
- ▣ *Happy are those who know they are spiritually poor.*
- ▣ E-earnestly believe He exists.
- ▣ *Happy are those who mourn, for they shall be comforted.*

1

Cont-

- ▣ C- consciously choose to commit
- ▣ *Happy are the meek*
- ▣ O-openly examine
- ▣ *Happy are the pure in heart.*
- ▣ V-voluntarily submit to every change
- ▣ *Happy are those whose greatest desire is to do what God requires.*

2

Cont-

- ▣ E-Evaluate all my relationships.
- ▣ *Happy are the merciful. Happy are the peace makers.*
- ▣ R- reserve a daily time with God
- ▣ Y-ield myself to God to be used
- ▣ *Happy are those who are persecuted because they do what God requires.*

3

B. Growing up emotionally: Coming home again in order to leave well.

- ▣ 1. Survival skills
- ▣ 2. Dysfunctional Family Roles:
- ▣ Enabler:
- ▣ Family Hero:
- ▣ Scapegoat:
- ▣ Mascot:
- ▣ Lost Child:

4

Cont-

- ▣ 3. Rules of the Dysfunctional Family.
- ▣ A. Do not talk...the real problem, no outside help. Nobody can know = secrets of the family.
- ▣ B. Do not feel...learned not to within the family of origin.
- ▣ C. Do not trust...learned not to within the family of origin.

5

Cont-

- ▣ D. Do not rock the boat: *keep things smooth, don't bring up problems.*
- ▣ *-So, things go un-dealt with in the relationships.*
- ▣ **RULES** = a set of expectations about how people should conduct themselves in various kinds of settings and circumstances.

6

4. Two Kinds of Family Rules

- ▣ A. Spoken: the easier rules that include...*Don't talk while you have food in your mouth.*
- ▣ B. Unspoken: *they may be understood and even agreed upon by family members, but they are not openly acknowledged or discussed.*
- ▣ Examples:
 - ▣ 1) *When things don't go your way, you cannot be angry, but you can be depressed.*

7

Cont-

- ▣ 2) When men in this family feel scared, they are supposed to deny the fear, even to themselves, and act angry instead.
- ▣ 3) Always appear happy and keep a stiff upper lip.
- ▣ 4) If you get angry, go away until you have cooled down and come back with a smile.

8

Cont-

- ▣ 5) Arguments are better than being too cool and indifferent: you show you care by fighting it out.

9

C. Taking charge of your attitudes through the Gospel

- ▣ 1. Blame = *the reaction of an aggressive attitude.*
- ▣ 2. Self Pity = *the reaction of a passive attitude.*
- ▣ Exercise: Read Acts 16:22-40

10

Acts 16: 22-40-Two reflection questions

- ▣ 1. What do you observe about Paul & Silas's attitudes, especially pertaining to the absence of blame & self pity??
- ▣ 2. If blame & self pity were used, how would this situation turned out differently?

11

D. Failure to claim our freedom through Christ.

- ▣ 1. Giving ground or territory to Satan.
- ▣ 2. Daily Prayer: Claiming our freedom through Jesus.

12

E. Forgiveness: The release towards rebuilding... Eph. 4:31-32

- ▣ 1. Resentment's Expressions...4:31
- ▣ a. Faces of resentment
- ▣ Bitterness=brooding grudge filled attitude.
- ▣ Wrath=wild intense inner rage, the passion of the moment.
- ▣ Anger=more subtle inner upset, sullen hostility.

13

External

- ▣ Clamor=shout of strife, reflects the public outbursts, loss of control.
- ▣ Slander=ongoing character assassination of another, rising from an inner root of bitterness.
- ▣ Malice=any of the above, alternating.

14

2. Resentment's release...4:31-32

- ▣ a. Letting go of the past
- ▣ (Primary versus secondary emotions)
- ▣ -Past History
- ▣ -Activating event: drop Dad's tool he yelled at me in rage.
- ▣ Primary emotion: fear, anxiety

15

Cont-

- ▣ Mental evaluation: I never do anything right when trying to help Dad.
- ▣ Secondary emotion: sad, depression

16

Forgive those who have offended you

- ▣ WHY??
- ▣ -required of God.
- ▣ -necessary to avoid entrapment by Satan.
- ▣ -standard operation for the believer.

17

WHAT?

- ▣ -forgiveness is not forgetting.
- ▣ -forgiveness doesn't mean you must tolerate sin.
- ▣ -forgiveness doesn't demand revenge or repayment for offenses suffered.
- ▣ -forgiveness means resolving to live with the consequences of another's sin.

18

How??

a. Preparation for forgiveness

- ▣ 1) Acknowledge the hurt and the resentment.
- ▣ 2) Let God bring the pain to the surface so He can deal with it.
- ▣ 3) Do not wait to forgive until you feel like it.

Principles of Emotional Maturity for Growth

- ◆ Principle 1: Look beneath the surface.
- ◆ A. Real change requires an inside look.
- ◆ 2. Quote: *An honest look at problems creates struggles that have more hope of leading to deep change than does a complacency supported by denial. Larry Crabb*

1

Principle 1 cont-

- ◆ B. Looking beneath the surface components.
- ◆ 1b. Jn. 2:23-24. *Jesus was not entrusting himself to some who claimed to believe, because he knew their hearts.*
- ◆ 1c. *Jesus consistently attempted to take the 12 below the surface in order for them to train them from the inside out.*

2

Principle 1 cont-

- ◆ 2. Asking the "why" or "what's going on" questions.
- ◆ -discover core motivations
- ◆ -what is the condition of your heart?
- ◆ -Using the new heart, given to you by God at salvation.

3

Principle 1 cont-

- ◆ 3. Linking the Gospel and Emotional Health
- ◆ A. Isa. 62:5...*As a bridegroom rejoices over his bride, so will your God rejoice over you.*
- ◆ B. *The Gospel = I am fully loved and accepted through Christ, therefore I obey. All that is necessary for us has already been done for us.*

4

C. Discipleship that leads to personal and relational transformation.

- ◆ 1a. Sanctification Heb. 10:10-14
- ◆ 10:10 *have been made holy*
- ◆ *Positional Sanctification*
- ◆ 10:14 *those who are being made holy*
- ◆ *Progressive Sanctification*

5

C. Cont-

- ◆ 1b. Teleios
- ◆ -Col. 1:28-to present each perfect.
- ◆ -Heb. 5:14-solid food is for the mature.
- ◆ -I Jn. 2:5-God's Word made complete in us.

6

C. cont-

- ◆ 1d. The process of transformation
- ◆ 1) Identify wrong feelings that help us discover wrong thinking. Rom. 12:2
- ◆ 2) Confess and acknowledge wrong thinking. I Jn. 1:9
- ◆ 3) Identify right thinking (truth) Rom. 12:2

7

1d. Cont-

- ◆ 4) Repentance that is Holy Spirit powered. I Thess. 1:9
- ◆ 5) Obedience

8

2. Relational Transformation

- ◆ 2a. Paraklesis
- ◆ IICor. 1:3-4...comforted by God, comfort others.
- ◆ Acts 13:15...if any encouragement, speak it.
- ◆ Heb. 3:13...encouragement is spiritual fighting for another.

9

2b. Relational Balance

- ◆ 1) Eccl. 4:12... cord of 3 strand can not be easily broken.
- ◆ 2) Matt. 22:36-39...Love God with your entire being, your neighbor as yourself.
- ◆ Do you see yourself in Christ, loved and redeemed???

10

D. Jesus invites us to embrace healing surgery. Lk. 13:1-9

- ◆ 2b. Exercise: Lectio Divinia
- ◆ 1st: What word or phrase stands out to you?
- ◆ 2nd: What do you feel as this is read?
- ◆ 3rd: What do you think God is saying to you as this is read?
- ◆ -make this the object of sharing and prayer for each other.

11

Cont-

- ◆ To have grace without truth = license.
- ◆ To have truth without grace = judgment, legalism, critical spirit.
- ◆ To have just time = stagnation or a worsening situation.

12

Change and healing requires:

- ◆ Learning/experiencing God's truth and grace through:
- ◆ -His Word, living and written
- ◆ -His incarnational people
- ◆ -in the process of redemptive time.

13

E. Three Dimensions of Transformation

- ◆ 1. Upward: Humbled by the Holy Presence of God.
- ◆ 1a. Pursued by God...James 4:8
- ◆ *Come near to God and He will draw near to you.*
- ◆ 1b. Humbled by holiness...Isa. 6:1-7
- ◆ *In the actual presence of God, he saw his sinfulness.*

14

**2. Dimension 2: Inward Transformation:
Developing Damage of Sin's Take Over**

- ◆ 1) Rebellion: LOSS OF DESIRE
- ◆ Inner statement: *I chose not to get life.*
- ◆ *Psm. 32:5b..My transgressions"*
- ◆ *Loss of desire: willful behavior, self-centeredness, and wicked desires.*
- ◆ *II Tim. 3:2-4 only a form of godliness, lovers of self*

15

Cont-

- ◆ 2) Guilt: LOSS OF INTIMACY
- ◆ -Inner statement: *There is a great gulf between me and God.*
- ◆ *Psm. 32:5c...guilt of my sins.*
- ◆ *Loss of Intimacy:*
- ◆ *-True moral guilt, separation from God, justice and punishment.*

16

Cont-

- ◆ 3) Shame :LOSS OF IDENTITY
- ◆ Inner statement: *I have lost my sense of identity and personhood.*
- ◆ *Psm. 32:3...when I kept silent.*
- ◆ *Loss of Identity and Inheritance:*
- ◆ *-condemnation, self rejection, low self esteem, fear, anxiety and hiding.*

17

Cont-

- ◆ 4) Bondage: LOSS OF CHOICE
- ◆ Inner statement: *I could never live.*
- ◆ *Psm. 32:4...your hand was heavy upon me.*
- ◆ *Loss of Choice:*
- ◆ *Compulsion, addiction, disease and blindness.*

18

b. Grace applied to the cycle of sin

- ◆ 1) Accept Christ's invitation to return to the Father.
- ◆ 2) Receive God's forgiveness and restore clear relationship with God.
- ◆ 3) Apply God's truth to replace old lies and develop a Christ-like identity as an hier.
- ◆ 4) Use God's power to overcome the world, the flesh and the devil.

19

3. Dimension 3: Outward Transformation

- ◆ Compelled to walk with pre-follower's into the presence of God through authentic relationships.
- ◆ -This is being missional, which first requires the development of a missional person through the 3 Dimensions of Transformation.

20

Church Leadership Style Inventory

Introduction: As we study the early Christian church, we see those who clearly appeared as one or the other of the following two styles. Uniquely, God used each of them in their respective roles. Let it be understood, both are essential to the ongoing work of God's Kingdom amongst us.

Purpose: The purpose of this inventory is to assist the student or leader in understanding which of the two styles of leadership most relates to how God has molded you for your role in His kingdom mission. There will be more information for understanding on the score sheet, which will be given to you separately.

Instructions: Please check the items below that would be truer of you, at least on most occasions. Check the statement that reflects your desire or style. Choose only one for each of the 6 items.

Column A:

Column B:

As a leader you are more:

- | | |
|---|---|
| 1. motivated to nurture the saints | ___ motivated to initiate new ministry |
| 2. ___ focused on stability | ___ focused on needed change |
| 3. ___ invested in building consensus | invested in blazing a trail for others |
| 4. inclined to have a full schedule | ___ inclined to allow space for new visions |
| 5. inclined to avoid risks | inclined to embrace risks |
| 6. ___ willing to work for gradual change | willing to seek God for dynamic change |

Total for Column A

Total for Column B

Your highest score is in Column _____

Scoring the *Church Leader's Style Inventory*

Instructions:

1. Total the number of check marks in both Columns' A & B.
2. If your column A is higher, this would suggest that you are more of a **Church Leader**.
3. If your column B is higher, this would suggest that you are more of an **Apostolic Leader**.

Considerations:

1. Both styles are essential and necessary. However, it is important to understand which one most describes your bent in ministry. It is good to understand this early in life in order to build well and wisely.
2. There is a place for both styles in the local church; however, apostolic leaders are often misunderstood by local church leadership and the local church. In the eventual frustration, apostolic leaders often migrate to apostolic structures such as mission agencies or para-church ministries.
3. Let it be understood, that if apostolic structures are in place, sanctioned and find partnership with the local church; apostolic ministry is released for the good of mission and the local church, together as part of God's kingdom work.
4. The partnership of church leader and apostolic leader is what I believe God intended. In this way, apostolic leaders can bring their needed influence to the local church, but not frustrate the mode of operation usually required for ongoing church health and development.

Review: Go back and read the statements on the previous page that summarize your leadership style. I would encourage you to write out the statements that you checked in a summary list fashion. Use this summary list as a basis of prayer and encouragement toward the part God will have you play toward advancing the Gospel and the expansion of His Kingdom.

WHO YOU ARE...AND WHAT IS HAS TO DO WITH WHAT YOU DO

“Achieving the same level of excellence does not mean you will necessarily gain the same level of accomplishment.”

Look At:

1. Hebrews 12:1
2. I Corinthians 9:24
3. II Timothy 4:7
4. Matthew 25: 14-30

Excellence means.....

You are truly successful when.....

Six categories of Strengths we each carry

1. **Work Suitcase:** Contains your life achievements earned on the job. “I have done...” statements.
2. **School Suitcase:** Holds your life education and training achievements. “I have a degree in.” and I know about...” statements.
3. **Personality Suitcase:** Filled with the inner qualities of your life; temperament, character, disposition, and personality characteristics. “I am the type of person who...” statements.
4. **Interests Suitcase:** Contains interests, concerns, attractions, and fascinations that you have collected in your life. “I like...statements.
5. **Values suitcase:** Carries all that is important to you now and in the future. These are deep seated convictions, motivations and commitments. “I believe...” statements.
6. **God-Given/Inherent talents suitcase:** Contains the inherent talents God selected to be part of you when He created **you**. They are uniquely God-given, not acquired by effort but develop through effort.

“Recognizing the relationship between your natural talents and your life journey goals is critically important to answering the questions, “who am I” and “what am I trying to accomplish?”

RECOGNIZING A BAD MATCH

Are you recognizing that the relationship between your natural talents and your life goals are miles apart?

In other words, does your Sixth Suitcase appear to have equipped you for your goals and ambitions, or does it suggest some refinement?

STRESS STATEMENTS OF FRUSTRATION OR ACTIONS:

___ They are constantly pushing to keep up.

___ They are consistently tired.

___ They talk of burnout.

___ They are defensive about the work they do.

___ They are either not willing to acknowledge, or actively critical of the accomplishments of others.

___ They are excessively competitive.

___ They are constantly trying to out-manuever others.

___ They are frustrated by lack of achievement.

___ They are depressed because they have tried so hard & have nothing to show for it.

___ They are criticized as being phony by those who are closest to them.

___ They are hard to get to know.

___ They are afraid others will find out who they really are.

___ They look for ways to impress others with clothes, money, or association with famous people.

___ They are desperate because they lack the approval of their spouse.

(The above lists fall under three foundational categories):

1. Distorted self concept.....Romans 12:3 - 8 or Ephesians 2:10
2. Excessive energy required to keep up with others in the same field.
3. Fear of failure.

Exercise: Take a piece of paper and time yourself for two minutes. Write out the possible finishing responses to the statement:

"I am tired of _____"

THINGS THAT TEND TO KEEP PEOPLE FROM OPENING AND APPLYING THE CONTENTS OF THEIR 6th SUITCASE;

1. Fear of losing a lifelong passion.

ASK: Are you denying obvious conclusions in an effort to protect your passion???

2. Failure to recognize your strengths.

THINK ABOUT: Will you deal with the areas of limitation in your makeup if you are not aware of your strengths?

3. Failure to correct our acquired prejudices.

ASK: How might these prejudices be interfering with our self-image and life goals, steering us away from certain career choices?

4. Testophobia.

ASK: Are you reluctant about self evaluation exercises and why?